

UPSC MODERN INDIAN HISTORY

The Decline of the Mughal Empire, 1707-1740s Complete Learning Session

Modern Indian History · Prelims + GS-I analytical foundation

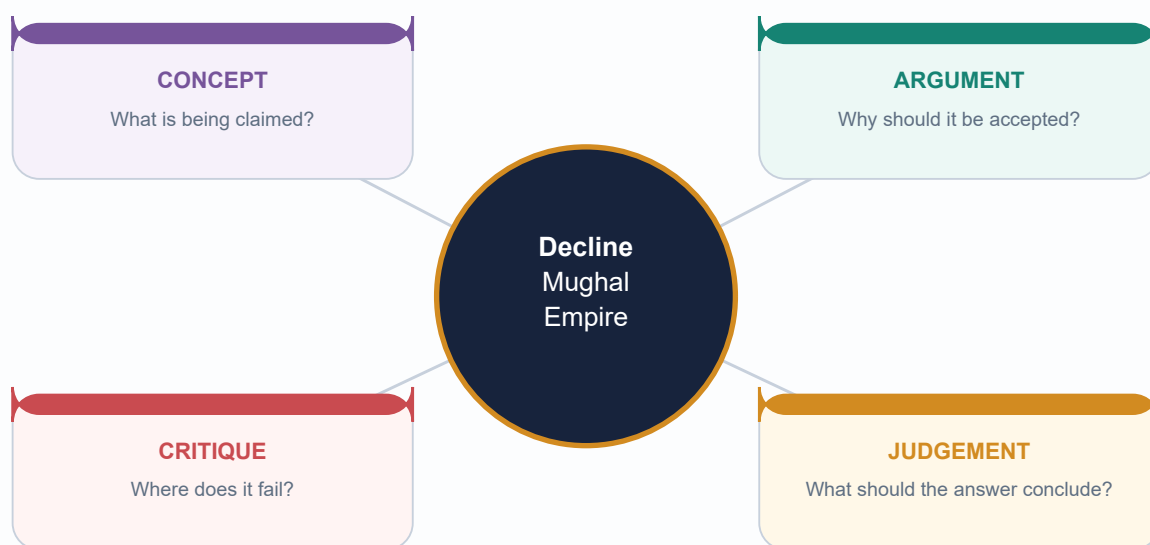
Scope: late-Aurangzeb background, 1707-1740s core, bounded post-1740 consequence

Rendering mode: main · Source:

01_The-Dcline-of-the-Mughal-Empire-1707-1740s_Complete-Topic-Package.md

Learning cards: 300

Approval state: generated, approved=false



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Package Overview

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Modern Indian History | **Paper:** Prelims GS-I + GS-I analytical foundation | **Topic:** 01 | **Regenerated:** 13 August 2026 greater than greater than **Evidence key:** FACT = supported by a named source/event/institution; INTERPRETATION = evidence-led analytical position; LIMIT = what the evidence cannot establish; METHOD = source-use rule; BOUNDARY = context deliberately kept outside the core period. greater than greater than **Approval state:** generated, **approved=false**. Status remains yellow until the user explicitly approves all three deliverables.

HIGH

Package practice counts · Matrix 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Package practice counts.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Component	Count
Verified/routed PYQs	3; two Prelims keys explicitly inferred, one verified adjacent GS-I Mains
Hard MCQs with explanations	48
Remedial MCQs with explanations	12
Original solved 10-mark Mains	3
Original solved 15-mark Mains	3
Original solved 20-mark Mains	3
Final register modules	15; placed last

HIGH

Sources actually used · Matrix 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Sources actually used.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Source class	Exact source	Use and caveat
Repository knowledge	Modern History Topic 01 basic/advanced; README; Master Chronology; Revision Chart; PYQ routing; Answer-Worthiness Audit; bounded Topic 02.	Controls scope, chronology, answer architecture, successor-state comparison, terminology and existing answer-worthiness upgrades.
Repository bridge	Medieval History Topic 25 basic/advanced.	Supplies late-Aurangzeb, jagirdari, Sayyid, Maratha and eighteenth-century continuity; later Panipat material is kept outside the core.
Local OCR book	Bipan Chandra, *Modern India*, Chapter I and bounded Chapter II.	Foundation for ruler sequence, multi-causal decline, nobility, agrarian stress, Nadir Shah and successor states; older generalisations are qualified.
Local OCR book	Satish Chandra, *Medieval India: From Sultanat to the Mughals, Part II*, sections on Aurangzeb, northern India and the Marathas.	Detailed control for jagir debate, Sayyid policies, Nizam, regional states, Nadir diplomacy and the caution against overstating economic collapse.
Local OCR book	Sekhar Bandyopadhyay, *From Plassey to Partition*, Chapter 1.	Historiographical bridge between conventional decline and revisionist regionalisation; quantitative claims are not repeated as timeless facts.
Named primary traditions	Khafi Khan; Dargah Quli Khan; Mirza Mahdi Khan Astarabadi; farmans, sanads, letters, Company records and regional traditions.	Used through source-critical synthesis; no uncertain quotation, casualty total or invitation story is asserted.
Material/official heritage	ASI and UNESCO Red Fort pages; National Museum manuscript collection; IGNCA/Rampur Mughal-Persian manuscript catalogue.	Bounded evidence for material continuity, the Peacock Throne setting, manuscript survival and conservation; no current-affairs item is forced.

HIGH**Sources actually used · Matrix 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Structured evidence matrix for Sources actually used.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Source class	Exact source	Use and caveat
Verified PYQ routing	Repository 2021 Prelims Q45/Q48 and 2022 GS-I Q2 route.	Questions are included; unavailable local official Prelims keys are marked inferred.

HIGH

Sources actually used · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bounded authoritative links

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Archaeological Survey of India, Red Fort: <https://asi.nic.in/pages/WorldHeritageRedFort>
- UNESCO World Heritage Centre, Red Fort Complex: <https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/231/>
- National Museum, manuscript collection: <https://www.nationalmuseumindia.gov.in/en/collections/index/11>
- IGNCA, *Mughal and Persian Paintings and Illustrated Manuscripts*:
<https://ignca.gov.in/divisionss/kalakosa/kalasamalocana/mughal-and-persian-paintings-and-illustrated-manuscripts/>
- No current-affairs item was forced. Qdrant was not used because repository Markdown, OCR-searchable local books and bounded official heritage sources were sufficient.

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact scope visual

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Meaning, scope and governing thesis.

MEANING, SCOPE AND GOVERNING THESIS: VISUAL SPINE

NECESSARY BACKGROUND

late seventeenth century
Deccan war, jagir pressure
agrarian and frontier strain

->

CORE ANALYTICAL WINDOW

1707 to the 1740s
succession, factions, regions
and Nadir Shah, 1739

->

BOUNDED CONSEQUENCE

after 1740
Durrani pressure and
later Company opportunity

The subject is the decline of imperial central authority, not the instant death of Mughal India.

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] The Mughal dynasty did not disappear in 1707. What contracted was the centre's capacity to appoint, transfer, tax, discipline and defend across the empire. Mughal emperors, titles, revenue vocabulary, coins, farmans and symbolic sovereignty survived far longer.
- [CONCEPT] **Decline** means loss of effective central fiscal-military authority. **Decentralisation** means power moving from Delhi to provinces and local intermediaries. **Regionalisation** means provincial, zamindari and military networks becoming durable political formations. **Eighteenth-century transition** combines central contraction with new regional orders.
- [LIMIT] "Disintegration" is accurate for the imperial command structure but misleading if used to imply that administration, trade, urban life, culture or legitimacy vanished everywhere.
- [THESIS] The best explanation is interactive: unresolved succession + competitive nobility + jagirdari and agrarian pressures + Deccan over-extension + regional military-fiscal mobilisation + weak command adaptation + frontier exposure. Nadir Shah accelerated and advertised the crisis; he did not originate it.
- [THESIS] Aurangzeb's choices mattered, especially the long Deccan commitment and difficulties with Marathas and some Rajput houses, but neither personal blame nor communal causation can explain the subsequent politics of jagirs, zamindars, successor states and noble coalitions.
- [SCOPE] Background before 1707 is included only where it explains inherited structures and strains. Developments after Muhammad Shah's death in 1748 are used only to show bounded consequences, not to turn this package into a survey of the whole eighteenth century.

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Decline versus transition matrix

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Meaning, scope and governing thesis.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Analytical term	Correct use	Evidence	Unsafe overstatement
Decline	Loss of enforceable authority at the imperial centre	succession wars, provincial remittance failure, Karnal	"Everything in India declined"
Decentralisation	Delegated office and revenue moved toward provincial control	Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad	"A complete political vacuum appeared"
Regionalisation	Local elites, financiers, zamindars and armies made new political arenas	Bengal revenue order, Awadh chiefs, Maratha networks	"All regions followed one identical path"
Transition	Old Mughal forms survived while the location and social basis of power changed	coin, khutba, mansab, Persian chancery, hereditary autonomy	"The old order ended in one event"

HIGH

Meaning, scope and governing thesis · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-safe governing thesis

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The Mughal crisis of 1707-1740s was a **decline of central imperial capacity inside a continuing Mughal political culture**. The centre lost resources and obedience faster than it lost legitimacy; provinces and armed regional groups appropriated imperial techniques; and the external shock of 1739 exposed a system already weakened by interacting fiscal, agrarian, military and political pressures.

HIGH

Evidence base and source criticism · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Source matrix

HIGH

Evidence base and source criticism · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Evidence base and source criticism.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Source family	Named examples	What it can establish	Genre or bias limit
Persian court chronicles	Khafi Khan, *Muntakhab al-Lubab*; later court histories used by Satish Chandra	succession, offices, factions, jagirs, policy and court language	elite and moralising gaze; access and patronage shape emphasis
Eyewitness and urban writing	Dargah Quli Khan, *Muraqqa-i Dehli*; Anand Ram Mukhlis's account of 1739	courtly culture, urban life, invasion experience and elite networks	Delhi-centred, selective and socially narrow
Persian conqueror's chronicle	Mirza Mahdi Khan Astarabadi, *Tarikh-i Jahangusha-yi Nadiri*	Nadir's campaigns, diplomacy and imperial self-presentation	triumphalist patronage text; numbers and motives need corroboration
Farmans, sanads and letters	Farrukhsiyar's 1717 Company farman; Maratha grants associated with the 1718-19 settlement; diplomatic correspondence with Nadir	legal claims, privileges, bargaining and intended hierarchy	an order proves a claim, not uniform implementation
Company records	English factory consultations, letters and commercial accounts from Bengal, Madras and Surat	trade privileges, remittances, urban markets and political risk	corporate and commercial bias; limited knowledge of inland society
Regional records	Maratha bakhars and correspondence; Rajput records; Sikh and Jat traditions	mobilisation, local political memory and regional claims	retrospective heroisation, lineage and sectarian framing
Material evidence	coins, seals, inscriptions, forts, palaces, tombs, urban fabric and the Red Fort	titulature, mint claim, patronage, continuity and spatial power	survival is selective; symbolic claim is not territorial control

HIGH

Evidence base and source criticism · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Method rules

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [METHOD] Convert every major claim into: **claim** → **named evidence** → **significance** → **limit**.
- [METHOD] A farman or sanad reveals what an authority wanted recognised. It does not by itself prove that customs officials, zamindars or Maratha commanders obeyed it.
- [METHOD] Coinage and the khutba are strong evidence of symbolic hierarchy. Their continuation under a successor state proves retained Mughal legitimacy, not direct daily control from Delhi.
- [METHOD] Court chronicles are strongest on offices, noble alliances, ceremonial precedence and war. Their silence is weakest evidence for peasant welfare, women's work, artisan agency or village-level implementation.
- [METHOD] Company records are precise about goods, customs and corporate disputes but cannot be treated as neutral descriptions of Indian politics.
- [METHOD] Invasion narratives tend to magnify armies, booty and casualties. This package therefore avoids a fixed casualty total for Delhi and treats famous booty estimates as contested.

HIGH**Evidence base and source criticism · 4****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

[METHOD] Material continuity matters: the Red Fort's Diwan-i-Khas and its former Peacock Throne setting, surviving coins and late-Mughal painting show that cultural production and symbolic sovereignty outlived the centre's military reach.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Source-use flow**

HIGH**Evidence base and source criticism · Visual 5****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Compact visual logic for Evidence base and source criticism.

EVIDENCE BASE AND SOURCE CRITICISM: VISUAL SPINE

QUESTION

|
 define the level: centre / province / locality / economy / culture
 |
 name the source: chronicle / farman / letter / coin / building / account
 |
 state what it proves
 |
 add genre, implementation, regional or numerical limit
 |
 give a graded verdict

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Evidence base and source criticism · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

UPSC traps

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- A contemporary source is not automatically neutral.
- A later regional memory is not useless, but its political purpose must be stated.
- A coin in the emperor's name proves a legitimacy claim, not direct imperial taxation.
- A story about court luxury cannot substitute for evidence on jagirs, army payment or provincial remittance.

HIGH

Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Institutional map

HIGH

Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Imperial structure inherited in 1707.

IMPERIAL STRUCTURE INHERITED IN 1707: VISUAL SPINE

EMPEROR

- mansab and office allocation
- jagir assignment / transfer
- khalisa revenue and imperial treasury
- farman, title, robe, seal and symbolic arbitration

SUBAH: subahdar (executive/military) + provincial diwan (revenue check)

SARKAR -> PARGANA -> village and revenue intermediaries

ZAMINDARS, qanungos, chaudhuris, cultivators, bankers and local armed followings

The system depended on circulation, audit, remittance and credible imperial arbitration.

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] The emperor stood at the apex of appointment and patronage. Mansabdars held numerical ranks and owed service; many were paid through transferable revenue assignments called jagirs rather than ownership of land.
- [FACT] **Khalisa** lands sent revenue more directly to the imperial treasury. Converting too much khalisa into jagir reduced the centre's cash flexibility, while withholding productive jagirs alienated nobles.
- [FACT] The official hierarchy ran broadly from **subah** → **sarkar** → **pargana** → **village**. The 2021 Prelims hierarchy question tests this inherited scale.
- [FACT] A provincial subahdar exercised executive and military power, while the provincial diwan represented an intended fiscal check. In practice, strong governors could bring both political and revenue networks under personal control.
- [FACT] Zamindars were not merely tax collectors. They possessed local rights, forts, armed retainers, clan or caste connections and knowledge of cultivation; imperial administration required their cooperation.
- [FACT] The mansab-jagir mechanism was both a military establishment and a political contract. It tied a mobile nobility to the emperor so long as assignments were credible and service was enforceable.

HIGH**Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · 4**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

[ANALYSIS] The system could govern diversity without uniform bureaucracy because it nested imperial authority within provincial and local intermediaries. Its strength was flexibility; its danger was that office-holders could appropriate delegated power when transfers and sanctions lost credibility.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Inherited strength and vulnerability

HIGH**Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · Matrix 5**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Structured evidence matrix for Imperial structure inherited in 1707.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Strength in 1707	Why it had worked	Vulnerability after 1707
Timurid legitimacy	dynasty arbitrated elite rank and succession	repeated succession wars made arbitration itself a prize
Transferable jagirs	prevented permanent local entrenchment	short tenure encouraged extraction; enforcement weakened
Composite nobility	drew talent from several regions and lineages	competition hardened when good assignments became scarce
Provincial delegation	extended rule over a vast empire	governors could convert office into hereditary autonomy
Gunpowder army	artillery, cavalry and fort war supported expansion	contingent shortfalls and divided command reduced effectiveness
Revenue depth	agrarian surplus financed court and army	high demand, jama-hasil gaps and rural resistance reduced remittance

HIGH**Imperial structure inherited in 1707 · 6**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Answer insight

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Mughal decline was not the collapse of an institutionless court. It was the failure of a sophisticated but relationship-dependent system to reproduce obedience, revenue and military service after expansion slowed and central arbitration weakened.

HIGH**Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · 1**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Causal background

HIGH**Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · Visual 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Compact visual logic for Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment.

LATE-AURANGZEB STRAINS: BALANCED ASSESSMENT: VISUAL SPINE

Deccan annexations and prolonged campaigning

- + unresolved Maratha resistance
- + incorporation of new Deccani and Maratha claimants
- + emperor's long absence from north India
- + Rajput, Jat, Satnami and Sikh tensions

|

v

more military cost + more claims on jagirs + weaker supervision

|

v

serious inheritance in 1707, but not an inevitable collapse

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH**Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · 3**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN****Core teaching****EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**

- [FACT] Aurangzeb left an empire still formidable in army, administration and prestige. Bipan Chandra explicitly notes that the system remained efficient enough in 1707 for recovery to be conceivable.

- [FACT] The long Deccan phase tied the emperor and large forces to southern warfare, added Bijapur and Golconda, and failed to extinguish mobile Maratha resistance.

- [ANALYSIS] Expansion widened obligations faster than reliable collection. New Deccani and Maratha entrants sought mansabs and jagirs, while contested territories did not always yield the assessed revenue on paper.

- [FACT] Conflict with Marwar after Jaswant Singh's death and difficulties with other Rajput houses weakened an alliance that had supplied military and political support, although Rajput-Mughal cooperation was later renewed.

- [FACT] Jat, Satnami and Sikh assertions involved local power and agrarian grievances as well as religious identities. Peasants and zamindars supplied the social base of several movements.

- [LIMIT] Religious measures, including the restoration of jizya, could alienate and symbolically narrow the imperial coalition. Yet later rulers and the Sayyids reversed such measures, while Hindu and Muslim elites repeatedly formed cross-religious alliances for power and revenue.

HIGH**Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · 4**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

[VERDICT] Aurangzeb's policies created or aggravated constraints; they do not alone explain why later nobles fought over the wizarat, why provincial governors built successor states, or why revenue assignments lost credibility.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**- Balanced responsibility table**

HIGH

Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Dimension	Aurangzeb-linked contribution	Qualification
Deccan	prolonged war, fiscal strain and administrative absence	Maratha resilience and Deccan political geography mattered independently
Jagirs	more entrants and assignments under wartime pressure	the crisis developed through later grants, transfers, corruption and remittance failure
Rajputs	Marwar conflict weakened an older alliance	many Rajput nobles later returned to high office
Religion	jizya and temple actions harmed coalition-building in places	political and class interests cannot be reduced to Hindu-Muslim blocs
Frontier	northwest received less attention during southern concentration	post-1707 courts also failed to rebuild diplomacy and defence

HIGH

Late-Aurangzeb strains: balanced assessment · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Memory hook

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- AURANGZEB = accelerator and inheritor of strain, not a communal single-cause explanation and not a complete answer.

MEMORY HOOK

Recall the claim-evidence-significance-limit chain.

HIGH

Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Succession tree

HIGH

Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713 · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713.

SUCCESSION AND COURT CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1713: VISUAL SPINE

Aurangzeb dies, 1707

- |
- +-- Muazzam -> Bahadur Shah I, victorious at Jajau
- +-- Azam Shah -> defeated and killed
- +-- Kam Bakhsh -> defeated in the Deccan, 1709

Bahadur Shah I dies, 1712

- |
- +-- Jahandar Shah, supported by Zulfiqar Khan
 - |
 - +-- defeated in 1713 by Farrukhsiyar backed by Abdullah Khan and Husain Ali, the Sayyid Brothers

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713 · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bahadur Shah I, 1707-1712

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Bahadur Shah was experienced, learned and conciliatory, not a caricature of immediate incompetence. He attempted accommodation with Rajputs, Marathas, Bundelas and Jats while campaigning against Banda Bahadur's Sikh movement.
- [FACT] He recognised Maratha **sardeshmukhi** in the Deccan but did not fully settle **chaauth** or the Shahu-Tarabai conflict. Conciliation without a stable enforcement formula left the Deccan unsettled.
- [FACT] Chhatrasal Bundela and Churaman Jat could be incorporated tactically; Banda's movement, however, remained a major Punjab challenge despite Mughal campaigning.
- [FACT] State finances worsened through promotions and jagir grants. Satish Chandra cites contemporary anxiety that armies required money that was no longer readily visible.
- [ANALYSIS] Bahadur Shah shows that a capable ruler could slow decline but could not simultaneously solve succession, Sikh resistance, Maratha bargaining, Rajput interests and the fiscal cost of elite accommodation.
- **Jahandar Shah and Zulfiqar Khan, 1712-1713**

HIGH

Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713 · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[FACT] Jahandar Shah's short reign depended heavily on the experienced wazir Zulfiqar Khan. The political problem was not simply royal frivolity; it was whether a powerful minister could govern without frightening emperor and rival nobles.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Zulfiqar pursued an inclusionist policy, abolished jizya, conciliated Rajputs, confirmed arrangements with Shahu and sought to restrain reckless jagir growth and enforce mansab contingents.
- [FACT] Revenue farming or **ijara** spread, transferring collection to contractors who promised a fixed sum and then pressed cultivators for profit.
- [ANALYSIS] A strong wazir offered administrative capacity but also created a coalition problem: the emperor feared replacement, old nobles feared exclusion and rivals organised alternative blocs.
- [FACT] Farrukhsiyar defeated Jahandar Shah in January 1713 with decisive Sayyid support. Throne-making now visibly depended on armed noble coalitions.

- **Chronology table**

HIGH

Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713 · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Succession and court chronology, 1707-1713.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Date	Ruler or event	Analytical significance
1707	Jajau and Bahadur Shah's accession	succession consumed military and political capital
1709	defeat of Kam Bakhsh	last major phase of Aurangzeb's sons' contest
1710-12	Banda Bahadur challenge	Punjab resistance remained unresolved
1712	Bahadur Shah dies; Jahandar Shah succeeds	no institutional rule of succession
Jan 1713	Farrukhsiyar triumphs	Sayyid military-political leverage becomes decisive

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Faction and office map

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720.

FARRUKHSIYAR, THE SAYYID BROTHERS AND KINGMAKER POLITICS, 1713-1720: VISUAL SPINE

EMPEROR FARRUKHSIYAR

| wants personal control through favourites and the imperial seal

X conflict over appointments, jagirs, army and provincial resources

SAYYID ABDULLAH KHAN (wazir) ----- SAYYID HUSAIN ALI (mir bakhshi / Deccan)

Rajput, Jat and Hindustani links

| Maratha negotiation and Deccan force

kingmaker coalition

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Abdullah Khan and Husain Ali Baraha had raised Farrukhsiyar to the throne. Their subsequent struggle was over the substance of sovereignty: who controlled appointments, the imperial seal, jagirs, the army and provincial resources.

- [FACT] The Sayyids pursued religious conciliation. Jizya and several pilgrim taxes were abolished; Rajput rulers received high ranks; Churaman Jat was accommodated; negotiation with Shahu produced Maratha grants.

- [FACT] In the 1718 settlement, formalised through imperial grants in 1719, Shahu's side gained recognition of swarajya and rights connected with chauth and sardeshmukhi in the Deccan in return for service and political support.

- [FACT] Farrukhsiyar's favourites attempted to bypass the wazir's office in appointments and seal business. Satish Chandra uses Khafi Khan to show the clash between an empowered ministry and personal royal rule.

- [FACT] The crisis aggravated jagir competition: court parties promised ranks and assignments to recruit armed followers, converting institutional scarcity into immediate factional mobilisation.

- [FACT] Farrukhsiyar was deposed and killed in 1719. Rafi-ud-Darajat and Shah Jahan II followed briefly before Muhammad Shah was installed. Counting Farrukhsiyar, four emperors occupied the throne during that calendar year.

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[FACT] Husain Ali was assassinated in 1720; Abdullah Khan's resistance was defeated. The Sayyid ascendancy ended, but kingmaking had permanently damaged the aura of unchallengeable monarchy.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Interpretation: symptom and agent

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

As symptom	As agent
emperors already needed noble military coalitions	deposition and killing of an emperor further reduced dynastic awe
jagir scarcity encouraged blocs	patronage promises intensified assignment competition
provincial resources mattered more than court title alone	Deccan and Maratha alliances shifted the balance at Delhi
composite politics continued	opponents weaponised race, religion and Timurid loyalty against them

HIGH

Farrukhsiyar, the Sayyid Brothers and kingmaker politics, 1713-1720 · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Balanced verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The Sayyids were not merely villains who "destroyed" the empire. They attempted conciliation and administration under severe constraints, but their use of deposition and puppet succession made the emperor visibly dependent on armed patrons. They reveal how structural scarcity and personal distrust turned the court into a battlefield.

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Political sequence

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre.

MUHAMMAD SHAH, NIZAM-UL-MULK AND THE SHRINKING CENTRE: VISUAL SPINE

1719 Muhammad Shah installed

1720 Sayyid power broken

1722 Nizam-ul-Mulk becomes wazir and proposes restraint/reform

1723-24 court resistance + Maratha pressure + Deccan opportunity

1724 Nizam defeats Mubariz Khan and consolidates Hyderabad

1730s regional autonomy deepens while Delhi retains symbolic primacy

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Muhammad Shah's reign, 1719-1748, brought chronological stability after rapid enthronements. Mughal prestige, artillery and administration still possessed recoverable strength in the early 1720s.

- [FACT] Nizam-ul-Mulk represented an able noble seeking to restore discipline: review jagirs, resume some khalisa, restrain revenue farming and reduce corrupt appointment practices.

- [LIMIT] His reform programme also protected old noble interests and included a proposed revival of jizya that contemporaries, including allied nobles, considered politically inopportune. Reform was itself factional.

- [FACT] Nizam left the wizarat, moved south and defeated Mubariz Khan at Shakar Kheda in 1724. Hyderabad thereafter exercised practical autonomy while retaining imperial forms.

- [ANALYSIS] Nizam's departure was not a formal declaration of independence. It was the conversion of high imperial office, Deccan networks and military capacity into a regional state.

- [FACT] Muhammad Shah's court continued to appoint, title and symbolically validate powerful nobles. Yet it lacked reliable cash, disciplined contingents and provincial obedience.

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] The sobriquet "Rangila" and stories of pleasure describe court culture but do not explain the fiscal-military crisis. A serious answer must distinguish patronage of music and painting from administrative failure.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Muhammad Shah: decline and cultural vitality

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Political contraction	Cultural continuity and change
Nizam leaves the centre; provinces retain revenue	Delhi remains a major courtly and urban centre
appointments become factional and monetised	late-Mughal painting develops intimate court and urban themes
army pay and contingent enforcement weaken	khayal receives important court patronage associated with Sadarang
Nadir defeats the imperial host in 1739	Persianate etiquette, poetry, music and manuscript culture continue

HIGH

Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk and the shrinking centre · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Answer insight

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Muhammad Shah's period embodies the central distinction of the topic: **the state at Delhi weakened, while the court and city remained culturally productive and symbolically consequential.**

HIGH

Nobility, factions and the politics of patronage · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Faction map

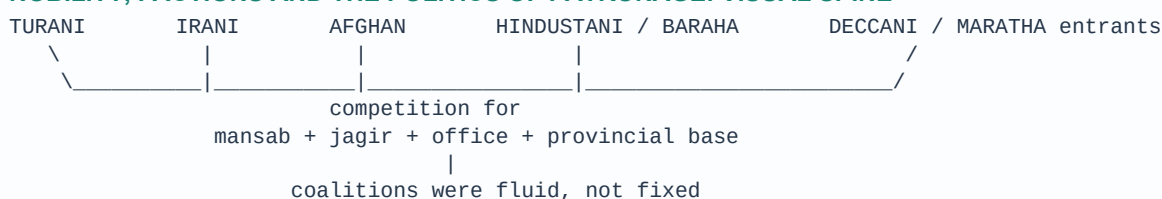
HIGH

Nobility, factions and the politics of patronage · Visual
2GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Nobility, factions and the politics of patronage.

NOBILITY, FACTIONS AND THE POLITICS OF PATRONAGE: VISUAL SPINE

*Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.*

HIGH

Nobility, factions and the politics of patronage · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Mughal nobles are commonly described as Turani, Irani, Afghan, Hindustani and Deccani groupings. These labels indicate origin, kinship and recruitment networks; they were not permanent modern political parties.
- [FACT] Competition centred on the wizarat, mir bakhshi's office, provincial governorships, productive jagirs, access to the emperor and control of armed followers.
- [ANALYSIS] Ethnic vocabulary could organise trust, but coalitions crossed origin and religion when office required it. Nizam's anti-Sayyid coalition invoked Timurid monarchy, "old nobility" and religion together.
- [FACT] Able figures were abundant: Zulfiqar Khan, the Sayyids, Nizam-ul-Mulk, Saadat Khan, Murshid Quli Khan, Jai Singh and others. The problem was not an absolute disappearance of talent.
- [ANALYSIS] Bandyopadhyay uses this evidence against a simple "incompetent personalities" thesis: capable nobles invested their ability in regional power or factional survival because the imperial reward system no longer aligned private ambition with central service.
- [FACT] Mansabdars facing inadequate yields often failed to maintain their full sanctioned contingents. A nominally large rank therefore did not guarantee soldiers ready for battle.

HIGH

Nobility, factions and the politics of patronage · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] Moral language about luxury and corruption appears frequently in chronicles. It is evidence of elite anxiety, but administrative mechanisms - assignment scarcity, arrears, sale of office and weak audit - explain more than private vice.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Claim-evidence-significance-limit example**
- **Claim:** Factionalism weakened the empire.
- **Evidence:** Farrukhsiyar and the Sayyids competed over seal, appointment and Deccan resources; in 1739 leading nobles could not agree on command at Karnal.
- **Significance:** Political division became military failure because no accepted authority could coordinate the host.
- **Limit:** Factions were produced partly by jagir and office scarcity, so they cannot be treated as an isolated moral cause.

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Jagirdari causal flow

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate.

JAGIRDARI AND MANSABDARI CRISIS: MECHANISM AND DEBATE: VISUAL SPINE

```

expansion slows + wartime entrants and promotions increase
      |
paper salary claims exceed dependable revenue assignments
      |
be-jagiri / delayed assignment + competition for productive jagirs
      |
short tenure and jama-hasil gap encourage rapid extraction
      |
peasants and zamindars resist / remit less
      |
nobles cut contingents; centre loses cash and coercive reach
      |
factional court + hereditary provincial power
  
```

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Terminology

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · Matrix 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Term	Meaning	Exam caution
Mansab	numerical rank and service status	not itself ownership of land
Jagir	assigned revenue claim used to meet salary/service obligations	transferable in principle; yields varied
Khalisa	revenue reserved more directly for the crown	shrinking khalisa weakened central cash
Jama	assessed revenue demand	paper assessment could exceed real collection
Hasil	revenue actually realised	jama-hasil gap reveals fiscal credibility problem
Be-jagiri	lack or delay of a suitable jagir for a claimant	structural scarcity, not a synonym for ordinary corruption
Ijara	revenue farming to a contractor	spread pressure and reduced direct administrative control

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Satish Chandra's structural thesis

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [INTERPRETATION] Satish Chandra locates a central mechanism in the mismatch between a growing body of claimants and dependable revenue-yielding jagirs. Competition for assignments fed noble faction and short-term extraction.
- [FACT] Frequent transfer was designed to prevent local entrenchment, but it discouraged long-term improvement and encouraged a jagirdar to maximise collection before transfer.
- [FACT] Granting khalisa land as jagir could temporarily placate nobles while depriving the central treasury of cash needed for transport, artillery, salaries and frontier defence.
- [FACT] The crisis became visible in court programmes to review ranks, resume assignments, check promotion and prohibit farming of crown lands.
- [ANALYSIS] Mansabdari and jagirdari were not separate problems: a rank without adequate assignment produced arrears; an assignment without audit weakened troops; a weakened army reduced collection.
- **Debate and qualification**

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · Matrix 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Interpretation	Core claim	Evidence used	Limitation
Satish Chandra	real structural shortage and low-yield assignments	be-jagiri, faction, transfers, depleted paibaqi	conditions varied by province and moment
Irfan Habib	agrarian crisis beneath elite fiscal crisis	heavy demand, peasant flight, zamindar-led resistance	resistance also arose from local opportunity and expansion
John F. Richards	parts of the crisis were policy-made; Deccan khalisa choices mattered	revenue existed but allocation and war finance distorted access	actual Deccan realisation and security remained uncertain
Revisionist regional view	resources did not simply vanish; they moved into regional networks	Bengal growth, bankers, revenue entrepreneurs, local agrarian expansion	regional vitality did not restore imperial coordination or protect all peasants

HIGH

Jagirdari and mansabdari crisis: mechanism and debate · 7

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The jagirdari crisis is strongest as a **mechanism connecting elite competition, rural extraction and military underperformance**. It should not be presented as a uniform quantified shortage across every province or as the only cause.

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Rural power chain

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers.

AGRARIAN AND FISCAL STRESS: PEASANTS, ZAMINDARS AND REVENUE FARMERS: VISUAL SPINE

imperial demand -> jagirdar / khalisa official / revenue farmer

|
zamindar and local staff|
cultivator, artisan and village credit

If demand rose while tenure shortened:

extraction -> flight / concealment / arrears -> armed zamindar resistance -> lower remittance

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Land revenue financed the imperial court and army. A weakening centre often responded by granting more assignments or demanding remittance, shifting pressure downward rather than solving the resource problem.

- [FACT] Ijara expanded in the early eighteenth century. Revenue farmers combined cash, local knowledge and coercive power; their profit depended on collecting above the contracted payment.

- [FACT] Bipan Chandra links heavy demand, transfer and revenue farming to peasant impoverishment, flight and uprisings associated with Satnamis, Jats and Sikhs.

- [FACT] Zamindars could withhold revenue, fortify positions and mobilise cultivators through locality, clan, caste or religious networks. They were both intermediaries of empire and possible leaders against it.

- [ANALYSIS] Peasant movements were not spontaneous class wars alone, nor merely religious rebellions. They often joined agrarian grievance to leadership by landed or warrior groups capable of sustained armed action.

- [REVISIONIST EVIDENCE] Bandyopadhyay notes that some regions experienced agricultural expansion, monetisation and stronger local lineages. New resources could empower regional actors even while the centre called their autonomy "rebellion".

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] "Agrarian crisis" must therefore be spatially differentiated: extraction and insecurity were severe, but production and commercialisation did not collapse uniformly.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Agrarian interpretation matrix

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Observation	Decline reading	Regionalisation reading	Combined answer
zamindars resist transfer or payment	breakdown of imperial discipline	local rights and armed capacity strengthen	weakening centre converts intermediaries into rulers
revenue farmers rise	predatory extraction and administrative decay	cash-rich entrepreneurs enter politics	commercial power and coercion combine
peasant participation	subsistence pressure and oppression	local solidarity and leadership matter	grievance needs organisation to become durable revolt
new cultivation in some areas	contradicts universal economic collapse	expands regional resource base	growth can coexist with conflict and unequal extraction

HIGH

Agrarian and fiscal stress: peasants, zamindars and revenue farmers · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

UPSC trap

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Do not write "the peasantry overthrew the Mughals." Rural resistance eroded collection and supplied regional movements, but leadership, weapons, forts, credit and political opportunity shaped outcomes.

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Chauth and sardeshmukhi

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Claim	Working meaning	Political significance	Caution
Chauth	conventionally one-fourth of assessed revenue claimed from a territory	paid in return for recognition or restraint from Maratha exaction	not an ordinary village land tax and not always collected uniformly
Sardeshmukhi	additional claim conventionally represented as ten per cent	asserted superior hereditary or regional fiscal right	legal claim and realised collection could differ
Swarajya	core dominion associated with Shivaji's state	dynastic and territorial recognition for Shahu	contested by rival Maratha houses and local chiefs

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Aurangzeb's campaigns did not destroy Maratha military capacity. Fort networks, mobile cavalry, local revenue knowledge and dispersed sardars allowed resistance to survive the fall of individual centres.
- [FACT] After 1707, Shahu and Tarabai represented rival Maratha legitimacies. Mughal policy attempted to manage this division rather than recognise one uncontested sovereign.
- [FACT] Bahadur Shah conceded sardeshmukhi but not a full settlement of chauth. Zulfiqar Khan and later the Sayyids moved further toward negotiated recognition.
- [FACT] The 1718-19 settlement associated with Husain Ali and Balaji Vishwanath linked Shahu's recognition and Deccan fiscal claims to military support for the Sayyids.
- [ANALYSIS] This was not simply Mughal surrender. It was an attempt to turn Maratha extraction into a regulated partnership; weak enforcement and competing commanders made the compromise unstable.
- [FACT] Under Baji Rao I from 1720, Maratha strategy shifted decisively toward Malwa, Gujarat and north Indian influence. Mobility allowed revenue claims to precede durable territorial administration.

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] "Marathas versus Mughals" is too simple. Maratha forces served Mughal factions; Maratha sardars competed among themselves; the Nizam bargained and fought with different Maratha interests.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Deccan interaction model

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · Visual 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge.

DECCAN LEGACY AND THE MARATHA CHALLENGE: VISUAL SPINE

Mughal campaign cannot eliminate dispersed Maratha power

court offers fiscal recognition for service

Maratha chiefs gain legal and revenue leverage

Nizam builds Hyderabad while bargaining/fighting with Marathas

Deccan becomes a multi-centred political field, not a clean secession

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Deccan legacy and the Maratha challenge · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Regional limit

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Maratha expansion strained Mughal and successor-state finances, yet reach did not equal uniform rule. Collection rights depended on negotiation, military presence and the cooperation of local elites.

HIGH

Jat, Sikh, Rajput, Bundela and zamindar assertions · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Regional assertion table

HIGH

Jat, Sikh, Rajput, Bundela and zamindar assertions · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Jat, Sikh, Rajput, Bundela and zamindar assertions.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Power or region	Named evidence within scope	Basis of assertion	Relation to Mughal order	Limit
Jats of Agra-Mathura	Churaman; fortified countryside and highway influence	zamindari, peasant support and local armed power	alternated between resistance, office and negotiated concession	later Bharatpur consolidation extends beyond the early window
Sikhs in Punjab	Banda Bahadur, Lohgarh and agrarian mobilisation	religious community, peasant support and armed organisation	Bahadur Shah first conciliated Guru Gobind Singh, then campaigned against Banda	misl and Ranjit Singh phases are later
Rajputs	Ajit Singh of Marwar, Jai Singh of Amber, Mewar diplomacy	dynastic states, mansabs and regional armies	high imperial office coexisted with demands for provincial control	Rajputs were not one united anti-Mughal bloc
Bundelas	Chhatrasal and Bundelkhand networks	local warrior-landed power	accommodation and autonomy could coexist	alliances changed with Mughal and Maratha pressure
Rohillas and Afghan chiefs	emerging Rohilkhand networks	military labour, settlement and local revenue	grew from weakened Mughal territories, not Durrani-created territory	major consolidation belongs partly to the later eighteenth century

HIGH

Jat, Sikh, Rajput, Bundela and zamindar assertions · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Jat mobilisation around Agra-Mathura drew strength from fortified villages, zamindari authority and peasant participation. Churaman could be both negotiated with and treated as a rebel.
- [FACT] Banda Bahadur's movement challenged Mughal authority across parts of Punjab after Guru Gobind Singh's death. Mughal capture of strongholds did not erase the social-military networks from which later Sikh power emerged.
- [FACT] Jai Singh and Ajit Singh sought mansabs, governorships and regional concessions. Their politics demonstrates that autonomy often operated through imperial office rather than formal separation.
- [FACT] Chhatrasal Bundela built substantial regional power while entering shifting accommodations. His career resists a simple loyalist/rebel binary.
- [ANALYSIS] These movements weakened the centre by withholding revenue, demanding office, controlling forts and forcing military expenditure. They also created institutions and elites later absorbed into regional states.
- [LIMIT] Religious identity shaped solidarity, but political economy - land, revenue, fortification, office and armed labour - explains why mobilisation became durable.

HIGH**Jat, Sikh, Rajput, Bundela and zamindar assertions · 4**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

[LIMIT] They did not jointly fight for a nation-state. Alliances frequently crossed faith and regional lines, and each pursued its own territorial and fiscal interests.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Memory hook**
- **J-S-R-B-Z: Jats, Sikhs, Rajputs, Bundelas and Zamindars turned local rights into bargaining power; none alone replaced the empire.**

MEMORY HOOK

Recall the claim-evidence-significance-limit chain.

HIGH**Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · 1**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Successor-state matrix

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

State	Foundational figure and date	Mughal continuity	Practical autonomy	Distinctive base
Bengal	Murshid Quli Khan; governorship confirmed 1717	Persian administration, imperial titles, remittance and formal sanction	appointments, revenue survey, transfer of jagirs, dynastic succession	rich agrarian-commercial zone; zamindars and bankers
Awadh	Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk appointed 1722	imperial governorship and continued court ambition	subdued chiefs, expanded subah and reduced effective financial dependence	middle Ganga revenue, local rajas and strategic location
Hyderabad	Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah; decisive consolidation 1724	coins, khutba, mansabs and nominal Mughal suzerainty	war, treaty, appointment and Deccan revenue controlled regionally	Deccan military aristocracy, revenue intermediaries and merchants

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bengal

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Murshid Quli Khan moved from diwan to governor and built a tight revenue order. Survey, punctual payment and reliance on large zamindars increased the provincial state's extractive capacity.

- [FACT] Bankers and merchants became indispensable to remittance and credit. The Jagat Seth house later gained strategic importance in provincial finance and the mint.

- [FACT] Formal ties to Delhi continued, including remittance, yet dynastic succession and provincial appointments increasingly occurred without effective central direction.

- [LIMIT] Strong collection could mean regional stability and commercial confidence for elites while increasing pressure on smaller zamindars and cultivators.

- Awadh

- [FACT] Saadat Khan received Awadh in 1722 and confronted local rajas and zamindars. His military and fiscal consolidation built a semi-autonomous state without renouncing Mughal sovereignty.

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[FACT] He continued to seek imperial office, showing that provincial and central ambition were complementary, not mutually exclusive.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Safdar Jung's succession was accepted through gifts and imperial confirmation after 1739-40, combining regional bargaining with Timurid legitimacy.
- [LIMIT] Awadh's later role as wazirate and buffer expands after the core period; this package stops at the formation logic.
- **Hyderabad**
- [FACT] Nizam-ul-Mulk converted the Deccan viceroyalty and his own military following into a durable state after 1724.
- [FACT] Mughal institutions survived but changed content: some jagirs became more hereditary, revenue intermediaries gained latitude and regional patronage displaced transfer from Delhi.
- [FACT] Coins and khutba continued in the emperor's name. This was not empty theatre; Mughal sanction remained a political asset among nobles and neighbouring powers.

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] Hyderabad did not control the Deccan uncontested. Marathas, Mysore, the Carnatic and local chiefs constrained its reach.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Nature of successor states**

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · Visual 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states.

HYDERABAD, BENGAL AND AWADH: SUCCESSOR STATES: VISUAL SPINE

MUGHAL PROVINCIAL OFFICE
+
regional military following
+
zamindar / banker / merchant support
+
declining transfer and audit from Delhi
=
HEREDITARY AUTONOMY WITH IMPERIAL LEGITIMACY

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh: successor states · 7

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Successor states were **continuities in administrative form and transformations in the location of sovereignty**. They did not produce a power vacuum; they produced a layered order in which Delhi remained the language of legitimacy but not the daily source of command.

HIGH

Regional map in text: a multi-centred political field · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Map

HIGH

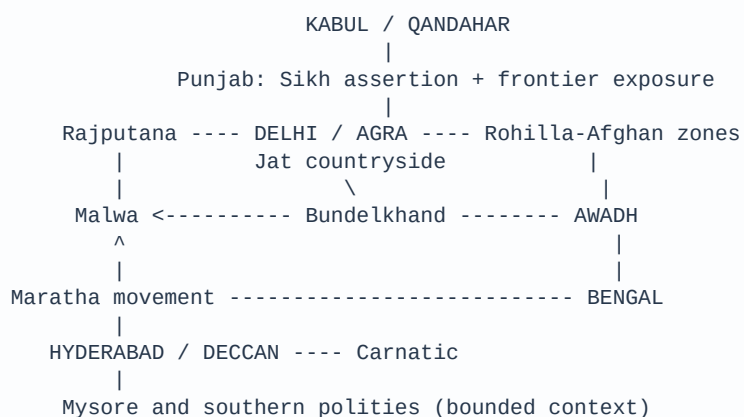
Regional map in text: a multi-centred political field · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Regional map in text: a multi-centred political field.

REGIONAL MAP IN TEXT: A MULTI-CENTRED POLITICAL FIELD: VISUAL SPINE



Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Regional map in text: a multi-centred political field · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

How to read the map

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Delhi retained titles, ceremonial authority and a strategic upper-Ganga core, but each corridor required cooperation from regional powers.
- Punjab combined imperial frontier defence, Sikh mobilisation and the route later used by Nadir Shah and Ahmad Shah Durrani.
- Agra-Mathura was not merely a road from Delhi; Jat fortification and zamindari power could disrupt communications.
- Malwa connected north India to the Deccan and became a major arena of Maratha expansion and Nizam-Maratha competition.
- Bengal's distance, revenue surplus and commercial networks made effective autonomy possible while symbolic Mughal links remained useful.
- Awadh connected the middle Ganga plain to Delhi and the northwest; its rulers could be provincial governors, regional sovereigns and imperial office-seekers at once.

HIGH**Regional map in text: a multi-centred political field · 4**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The map shows why "fragmentation" did not produce isolated boxes. Revenue, troops, bankers, pilgrims, merchants and diplomatic letters continued to move across political boundaries.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**- UPSC map use**

- In a Mains answer, draw a simple north-centre-east-Deccan arrow map to show that the crisis was spatial: frontier shock in the northwest, regional fiscal consolidation in the east, agrarian-zamindari assertion around the core and Maratha pressure from the Deccan.

HIGH**Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · 1**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Comparative military matrix

HIGH**Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · Matrix 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Structured evidence matrix for Military organisation, technology, command and logistics.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Dimension	Mughal strength inherited	Early eighteenth-century limit	Comparative implication
Cavalry	large mansab-based mounted establishment	paper ranks, arrears and incomplete contingents	numerical claims overstated field-ready force
Artillery	prestigious heavy guns and experienced gunners	slow movement and divided command	hardware without coordination could not decide battle
Infantry and firearms	musketeers and fort garrisons existed	no consistent integrated drill across noble contingents	avoid "Mughals had no guns" explanations
Command	emperor and great nobles could mobilise major hosts	precedence disputes and factional distrust	Karnal was an organisational as well as tactical defeat
Logistics	agrarian revenue, transport staff and road networks	cash shortage, forage and fragmented remittance	prolonged campaigning became harder
Frontier system	Kabul-Peshawar-Lahore chain, diplomacy and tribal subsidies	neglect, delayed intelligence and weak reinforcement	Nadir advanced before coherent defence formed

HIGH

Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · 3

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] The Mughal army was not a single standing national army. Imperial forces combined household troops, noble contingents, artillery, infantry, local levies and allied rulers.
- [FACT] Mansabdars were required to maintain troops according to rank, but fiscal strain and weak inspection encouraged shortfalls.
- [ANALYSIS] Heavy artillery and large camps were not inherently obsolete; they became liabilities when command was divided, movement slow and battlefield initiative uncoordinated.
- [FACT] Nadir's force possessed an advantage in unified command, mobility, disciplined fire and flexible light artillery. The contrast was organisational integration, not a simple firearm/no-firearm divide.
- [FACT] At Karnal, disputes over who should command and uncoordinated action by leading nobles allowed defeat in detail. Khan-i-Dauran was mortally wounded; Saadat Khan and Nizam-ul-Mulk were captured or compelled into submission.
- [LIMIT] Military "technological backwardness" is too broad for 1739. Mughal India had artillery, skilled metalwork and arms production; the problem was converting resources into a coherent, paid and responsive field force.

HIGH

Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[BOUNDARY] European companies were present as armed commercial corporations with fortified settlements and maritime support, but before the 1740s they were not yet the paramount explanation for Mughal decline.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Military-fiscal loop**

HIGH

Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · Visual 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Military organisation, technology, command and logistics.

MILITARY ORGANISATION, TECHNOLOGY, COMMAND AND LOGISTICS: VISUAL SPINE

unreliable jagir yield → incomplete contingents → weaker collection

$$\begin{array}{c}
 \wedge \\
 | \\
 \text{more arrears} \leftarrow \text{less remittance} \leftarrow \text{local resistance} \\
 \downarrow \qquad \qquad \qquad \downarrow
 \end{array}$$

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Military organisation, technology, command and logistics · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Answer verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The military crisis was a **fiscal-command crisis expressed on the battlefield**. Technology mattered, but organisation, pay, mobility, intelligence and coalition discipline determined whether technology could be used.

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Economy balance sheet

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Evidence of disruption	Evidence of continuity or vitality
warfare damaged routes and cultivation in contested zones	Bengal's agrarian and textile economy supported strong provincial finance
revenue farming and short-term extraction burdened cultivators	bankers and merchants financed remittance and regional courts
Delhi's treasury and northern circuits suffered in 1739	Satish Chandra notes Delhi remained a trade, craft and finance centre after the invasion
Deccan war harmed local production and transport	ports, inland markets and merchant networks continued across political boundaries
provincial remittance to Delhi declined	resources were often retained and reinvested regionally rather than disappearing

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Mughal political integration had supported roads, markets, mints, urban demand and large craft industries. Central decline disturbed some of these circuits but did not erase them.
- [FACT] Bengal's revenue and commerce allowed Murshid Quli Khan's regime to combine strong collection with merchant-bankers and a growing provincial capital.
- [FACT] Indian merchants remained important in inland and maritime trade. Company records reveal commercial competition and negotiation, not an already complete European monopoly.
- [FACT] Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman granted the English Company important Bengal trade privileges. Later conflict grew around the use and abuse of passes and private trade; the farman was not a grant of territorial sovereignty.
- [ANALYSIS] Less remittance to Delhi could appear as imperial fiscal decline while simultaneously strengthening regional courts, zamindars and financiers.
- [FACT] Nadir's invasion removed treasury wealth and disrupted Delhi, yet Satish Chandra warns that the economic effect of famous booty totals is often overstated; the city remained an important centre afterwards.

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] Revisionist vitality does not mean a regional golden age. War, exaction and credit dependence could enrich large intermediaries while exposing peasants, artisans and small traders to insecurity.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Company presence: bounded context

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · Visual 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality.

TRADE, ECONOMY AND URBAN CENTRES: CONTRACTION WITH REGIONAL VITALITY: VISUAL SPINE

commercial privilege (1717 farman)

factories + private trade + fortified settlements

political bargaining with regional states

later military-fiscal expansion after the core period

Opportunity was created by a competitive multi-state field; conquest was not automatic in 1707.

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Trade, economy and urban centres: contraction with regional vitality · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The safest economic conclusion is **uneven redistribution**: some imperial circuits and war zones declined, while regional agrarian, banking, artisanal and commercial centres remained vigorous.

HIGH

Court and culture under Muhammad Shah · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Culture-state distinction

HIGH

Court and culture under Muhammad Shah · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Court and culture under Muhammad Shah.

COURT AND CULTURE UNDER MUHAMMAD SHAH: VISUAL SPINE

weaker provincial obedience != absence of cultural production

court patronage -> music, painting, poetry, etiquette and manuscripts

urban networks -> performers, ateliers, merchants and connoisseurs

regional courts -> dispersal and adaptation of Mughal forms

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Court and culture under Muhammad Shah · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Core teaching

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Muhammad Shah's court is associated with important patronage of music, including the development of khayal through musicians such as Niyamat Khan "Sadarang".

- [FACT] Late-Mughal painting shifted toward intimate court scenes, portraits, festivals, leisure and urban life. These works are material evidence for patronage and social worlds, not proof of good government.

- [SOURCE] Dargah Quli Khan's *Muraqqa-i Dehli* depicts a lively city of nobles, performers, shrines and markets during the Muhammad Shah period.

- [FACT] Persian remained central to administration and elite literary culture, while regional courts and vernacular traditions expanded.

- [ANALYSIS] Provincial autonomy redistributed patronage. Artists, scribes, musicians and administrators could move to Awadh, Bengal, Hyderabad and other centres, carrying Mughal forms into regional idioms.

- [MATERIAL LINK] The Red Fort remained a powerful spatial symbol. ASI identifies the Diwan-i-Khas as the setting of the Peacock Throne later carried away by Nadir Shah; UNESCO treats the complex as a layered symbol of power and later political change.

HIGH

Court and culture under Muhammad Shah · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[LIMIT] The label "decadent court" converts aesthetic preference into a causal theory. Luxury may appear in moralising sources, but culture cannot explain jagir scarcity, rural resistance or frontier failure.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Evidence and inference

HIGH

Court and culture under Muhammad Shah · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Court and culture under Muhammad Shah.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Evidence	Safe inference	Unsafe inference
music and painting patronage	cultural production continued despite contraction	pleasure caused imperial collapse
urban chronicle	Delhi retained social and commercial vitality	every social group prospered
regional spread of artists	patronage decentralised	Mughal culture disappeared from Delhi
Red Fort and throne memory	symbolic sovereignty remained legible	monumental splendour guaranteed military power

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Campaign route

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · Visual 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739.

NADIR SHAH'S INVASION, KARNAL AND DELHI, 1738-1739: VISUAL SPINE

Safavid collapse and Nadir's rise

Qandahar captured, 1738

Kabul -> Peshawar -> Lahore

Karnal, 24 February 1739

Muhammad Shah submits; march to Delhi

violence, massacre and negotiated plunder

withdrawal with booty and territories west of the Indus

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why Nadir invaded

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Nadir had rebuilt Persian power through prolonged war and required resources to sustain a large military establishment.
- [FACT] He cited Afghan fugitives and Mughal failure to seal the frontier in diplomatic exchanges. Satish Chandra treats these complaints as a pretext rather than a sufficient cause.
- [FACT] Qandahar, Kabul and the northwest gateway had lost effective Mughal reinforcement. Delhi failed to respond coherently to repeated embassies and warnings.
- [FACT] India's accumulated treasury wealth and visible political weakness made invasion attractive.
- [LIMIT] Stories that Nizam-ul-Mulk or Saadat Khan invited Nadir lack documentary proof in Satish Chandra's assessment and should not be stated as fact.
- **Karnal**

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[FACT] The conventional modern date of the battle is **24 February 1739**. The Mughal camp included Muhammad Shah, Nizam-ul-Mulk, Saadat Khan and Khan-i-Dauran.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Mughal nobles disagreed over command and plan. Saadat Khan engaged without an integrated strategy; Khan-i-Dauran moved to support him and was mortally wounded.
- [FACT] Nadir's unified command, mobile firepower and tactical control defeated a larger but fragmented imperial host.
- [ANALYSIS] Karnal was the compressed battlefield expression of the wider crisis: paper strength without coordination, noble precedence without common command and a frontier system without timely response.
- [LIMIT] Avoid legendary army totals and claims that the battle alone destroyed the empire.
- **Delhi**
- [FACT] Muhammad Shah submitted and accompanied Nadir to Delhi. After violence against Persian soldiers amid a rumour that Nadir had been killed, Nadir ordered a massacre.

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[DISCIPLINE] No fixed casualty number is used here because contemporary and later estimates vary widely and are shaped by the rhetoric of catastrophe.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [FACT] Nadir seized the imperial treasury, levied contributions and took celebrated objects including the Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor.
- [FACT] Muhammad Shah retained the throne, while territories west of the Indus and frontier possessions including Thatta passed to Nadir's control.
- [FACT] Nadir withdrew; he did not establish Persian government over Delhi or the Gangetic plain.
- **Consequence matrix**

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · Matrix 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Dimension	Consequence	Qualification
Prestige	emperor and capital visibly subordinated	Mughal legitimacy still remained useful afterwards
Frontier	loss west of Indus opened the route to later Afghan pressure	Durrani invasions began after Nadir's death, outside the main window
Finance	treasury and elite wealth were removed; fiscal confidence weakened	exact booty totals are contested; regional economy did not uniformly collapse
Court	Khan-i-Dauran and Saadat Khan died; old alignments were disrupted	new factions formed instead of institutional recovery
Regions	zamindars and provincial rulers saw central weakness	regional autonomy was already advanced before 1739
Companies	foreign merchants observed the loss of imperial coercive capacity	Company conquest required later wars, alliances and Bengal revenue

HIGH

Nadir Shah's invasion, Karnal and Delhi, 1738-1739 · 7GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Bounded post-1740 consequence

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Nadir's assassination in 1747 enabled Ahmad Shah Durrani to build Afghan power. His first invasion in 1748 was checked near Sirhind, showing that Mughal resistance had not vanished; repeated later invasions nevertheless exploited the frontier opened in 1739. Those later events are consequences, not causes within this package's core period.

HIGH

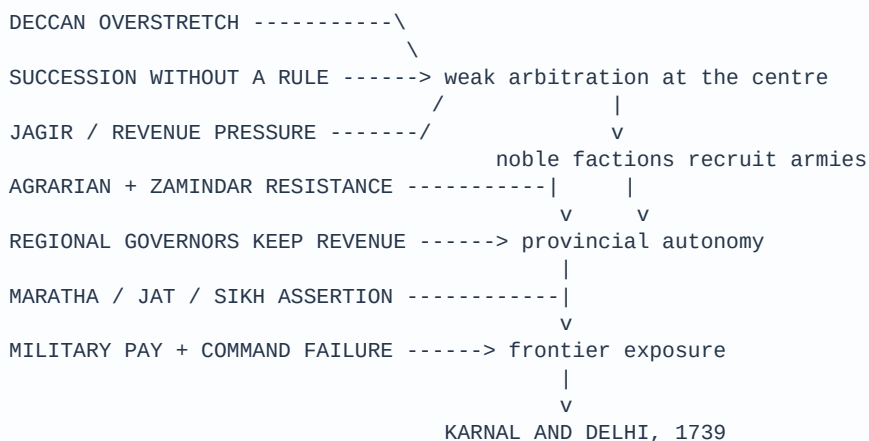
Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Interaction diagram

HIGH

Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · Visual 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Compact visual logic for Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model.

WHY CENTRAL AUTHORITY DECLINED: MULTI-CAUSAL INTERACTION MODEL: VISUAL SPINE

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Weighted causal hierarchy

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Structural fiscal-military core:** the mansab-jagir contract became less credible because dependable assignments, actual collection and service obligations diverged.
- **Political transmission mechanism:** succession wars and factional control of office prevented the emperor from arbitrating elite competition.
- **Rural and regional feedback:** extraction and weak supervision strengthened zamindars, peasants, regional governors and armed entrepreneurs.
- **Deccan and Maratha pressure:** prolonged war consumed resources and then converted Maratha forces into autonomous collectors and imperial brokers.
- **Military-organisational failure:** contingent shortfalls, arrears, slow logistics and divided command reduced the usable strength of the army.
- **External shock:** Nadir Shah exploited and publicised the weakness, further reducing prestige and frontier security.

HIGH

Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why single-cause explanations fail

HIGH

Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · Matrix 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Single cause	What it correctly notices	What it misses
weak successors	succession and royal judgement mattered	capable nobles and deep institutional pressures
Aurangzeb's religion	coalition and legitimacy could be damaged	post-1707 reversal, cross-religious alliances and fiscal mechanisms
noble corruption	appointments, bribery and self-interest weakened service	why incentives changed and resources became contested
peasant revolts	revenue pressure reduced collection	elite leadership, regional growth and political opportunity
Maratha attacks	mobile fiscal-military competition drained provinces	Mughal-Maratha bargaining and internal imperial crisis
Nadir Shah	invasion devastated prestige and frontier security	decline and regional autonomy already preceded 1739
European superiority	later companies possessed maritime-financial advantages	Company territorial rule was not the cause of the 1707-1739 crisis

HIGH

Why central authority declined: multi-causal interaction model · 6

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Synthesis

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The decline was a **self-reinforcing loop**. Fiscal stress weakened service; weak service reduced collection; lower collection intensified jagir competition; factional conflict encouraged provincial autonomy; autonomy deprived the centre of resources; and the diminished centre could neither control regional powers nor defend the frontier.

HIGH

Continuities after political contraction · 1

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Continuity map

HIGH

Continuities after political contraction · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Continuities after political contraction.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Surviving Mughal element	Evidence in the transition	Why it mattered
Timurid emperor	rival nobles and provinces still sought titles and confirmation	legitimacy reduced the cost of claiming rule
Coin and khutba	successor states retained the emperor's name	sovereignty remained layered rather than abruptly national
Mansab and office vocabulary	Nizam, Awadh and Bengal used imperial ranks and posts	administrative personnel and expectations remained portable
Revenue institutions	jagir, khalisa, zamindar, diwan and Persian records continued	regional states inherited a working fiscal language
Farman and sanad	Company and Maratha rights were framed through imperial grants	legal memory shaped later disputes
Persianate culture	chronicles, painting, music, etiquette and chancery practice continued	regional courts localised rather than discarded Mughal forms
Delhi as symbol	control of emperor and capital remained politically valuable	later Marathas and Company used Mughal sanction

HIGH**Continuities after political contraction · 3**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN****Core teaching****EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**

- [FACT] Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad did not initially declare modern sovereignty. They retained imperial forms because those forms remained intelligible to nobles, zamindars, merchants and neighbouring rulers.
- [FACT] Regional rulers sought confirmation, titles and succession approval through gifts and court diplomacy even while withholding effective obedience.
- [FACT] Maratha leaders sought formal sanads for fiscal rights. Imperial recognition could convert repeated exaction into a claim of lawful collection.
- [FACT] The Company relied on Farrukhsiyar's farman and later Mughal grants in its legal-political arguments. A weakening emperor could still issue documents with consequences.
- [ANALYSIS] Symbolic sovereignty was not the opposite of real power. It was a resource that regional powers used to stabilise new authority.
- [CULTURE] Administrative Persian, courtly forms, music, painting and architecture moved into regional capitals. The political centre fragmented more quickly than the cultural-administrative ecumene.

HIGH

Continuities after political contraction · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

[VERDICT] Mughal power declined before Mughal legitimacy. This gap explains why the dynasty survived as a political symbol long after Delhi ceased to command the empire.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Memory hook**

- **FORM SURVIVED, FORCE SHIFTED:** titles, coins, khutba, revenue language and Persianate culture remained; enforceable command and remittance moved to regions.

MEMORY HOOK

Recall the claim-evidence-significance-limit chain.

HIGH

Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Historiographical debate

HIGH

Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition?.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Historian or school	Main emphasis	Evidence contribution	Limitation or reply
Jadunath Sarkar and older imperial narratives	Aurangzeb, weak successors, moral and military decline	ruler-centred chronology and political narrative	risks communal, moralising and teleological explanation
Satish Chandra	jagirdari crisis, Deccan strain, factions and administrative-social mechanism	links elite assignment to rural and military effects	should not be universalised without regional variation
Irfan Habib / Aligarh materialist approach	agrarian crisis and surplus extraction	places peasants, zamindars and revenue relations beneath court politics	resistance did not always mean falling production
M. Athar Ali	composition and politics of Mughal nobility; critique of over-decentralised readings	explains elite structure and continuing imperial cohesion	court evidence can overshadow local networks
John F. Richards	allocation choices and Deccan khalisa complicate a simple shortage thesis	asks whether crisis was policy-made as well as resource-made	actual realisation, insecurity and service obligations still constrained the system
Muzaffar Alam	regional politics and continuing Mughal idiom in Awadh and Punjab	shows decentralisation without instant institutional rupture	regional formation involved conflict and unequal social costs
C.A. Bayly	commercial, credit and "portfolio" resources of local groups	reveals bankers, merchants and local elites as political actors	commercial vitality cannot erase imperial military decline

HIGH**Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · Matrix 3**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Structured evidence matrix for Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition?.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Historian or school	Main emphasis	Evidence contribution	Limitation or reply
Revisionist synthesis	eighteenth century as transition and regionalisation	explains Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad and urban-cultural vitality	can understate war, peasant pressure and the centre's real collapse

HIGH

Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · 4

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Dark-age debate

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- [ARGUMENT FOR DECLINE] The imperial treasury, army discipline, frontier and provincial remittance deteriorated. Delhi suffered catastrophic violence in 1739, and warfare burdened cultivators and trade routes.

- [ARGUMENT AGAINST UNIVERSAL DECLINE] Bengal and other regions retained commercial vitality; local agrarian expansion and banking networks financed successor states; Delhi's cultural and economic life recovered; Mughal institutions remained productive outside the centre.

- [BEST VERDICT] "Dark age" is too total, while "regional vitality" is too celebratory. The period combined central fiscal-military collapse, regional state formation, continuing commerce and culture, and uneven social suffering.

- **Historiographical answer flow**

HIGH

Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · Visual 5

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition?.

HISTORIOGRAPHY: DARK AGE, CRISIS OR REGIONAL TRANSITION?: VISUAL SPINE

define the level of decline

- > older ruler-centred explanation
- > structural jagirdari and agrarian explanation
- > revisionist regional evidence
- > source and regional limits
- > two-level verdict: centre declined, regions reorganised unevenly

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

Historiography: dark age, crisis or regional transition? · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Source-critical verdict

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Historiography improves the answer when each interpretation is tied to its evidence. Do not merely list historians. Use Sarkar for the older political thesis, Chandra and Habib for mechanisms, Richards for qualification, and Alam/Bayly for regional redistribution.

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Timeline ladder

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · Matrix 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Date	Event	One-line significance
1680s-1707	final Deccan phase under Aurangzeb	military-fiscal over-extension and unresolved Maratha resistance
1707	Aurangzeb dies; Jajau	succession reopens elite competition
1709	Kam Bakhsh defeated	succession among Aurangzeb's sons ends
1712	Bahadur Shah dies	rapid court instability follows
1713	Farrukhsiyar installed	Sayyid kingmaker power becomes decisive
1717	Bengal governorship of Murshid Quli; Company farman	regional autonomy and commercial privilege deepen
1718-19	Sayyid-Maratha settlement and sanads	Maratha fiscal claims enter imperial bargaining

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · Matrix 3

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Date	Event	One-line significance
1719	Farrukhsiyar deposed; rapid emperors; Muhammad Shah installed	monarchy visibly dependent on noble coalitions
1720	Sayyid power overthrown	Turani-led counter-coalition restores but cannot repair the centre
1722	Nizam becomes wazir; Saadat Khan appointed Awadh	reform at Delhi and state formation in the province
1724	Nizam consolidates Hyderabad	office becomes hereditary regional power
1730s	Maratha expansion in Malwa and Gujarat	Deccan challenge becomes north Indian fiscal pressure
1739	Karnal and Delhi	external shock exposes the hollowed fiscal-military core
1740	Alivardi Khan takes Bengal	bounded marker of stronger regional autonomy

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · Matrix 4

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Date	Event	One-line significance
1747-48	Nadir dies; first Durrani invasion; Muhammad Shah dies	post-1740 frontier consequence, not core cause

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 5

GS-I Modern Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Terminology bank

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Mansab**: numerical rank defining status and service obligation.
- **Jagir**: transferable revenue assignment used to meet salary and service.
- **Khalisa**: land revenue more directly reserved for the crown.
- **Be-jagiri**: absence or delay of a suitable jagir for a claimant.
- **Jama / hasil**: assessed demand / revenue actually realised.
- **Ijara**: revenue farming to a contractor.

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 6

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subah / sarkar / pargana: descending territorial-administrative units.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Wazir:** chief minister and central coordinator, especially of finance and administration.
- **Mir bakhshi:** high military-pay and mansab office.
- **Chauth / sardeshmukhi:** Maratha fiscal claims conventionally represented as one-fourth and an additional ten per cent.
- **Khutba:** Friday sermon in a ruler's name, a marker of acknowledged sovereignty.
- **Farman / sanad:** imperial order / documentary grant or confirmation.
- **Successor state:** a Mughal province converted into hereditary practical autonomy while retaining imperial forms.

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 7

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Memory hooks

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **S-J-A-M-N:** Succession → Jagir pressure → Agrarian resistance → Military weakness → Nadir.
- **B-A-H:** Bengal, Awadh, Hyderabad = provincial office + regional resources + nominal homage.
- **FORM/FORCE:** Mughal form survived; coercive force shifted.
- **1739 is an X-ray, not the disease:** Karnal exposed structures already weakened.
- **Centre versus region:** political contraction at Delhi can coexist with commercial and cultural vitality elsewhere.
- **High-frequency traps**

MEMORY HOOK

Recall the claim-evidence-significance-limit chain.

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 8

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The empire did not end in 1707.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Sayyid Brothers were kingmakers, not emperors.
- Nizam-ul-Mulk did not proclaim a modern independent nation-state in 1724.
- Chauth was not a religious tax.
- Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad were not identical.
- Nadir Shah did not annex and govern the Gangetic plain.
- Do not quote a Delhi massacre casualty total as settled fact.

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 9

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Do not call the eighteenth century uniformly stagnant.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Do not treat Mughal artillery as absent; coordination and logistics were the issue.
- Do not project later British paramountcy backward as inevitable.
- **Mark-scaled answer architecture**

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · Matrix 10

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured evidence matrix for Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit.

EVIDENCE AND COMPARISON MATRIX

Marks	Structure	Evidence density
10	direct thesis + three causal/evidentiary blocks + one qualification + verdict	2-3 named units
15	thesis + structural mechanism + political/rural interaction + counter-evidence + verdict	4-6 named units
20	define level + weighted causal hierarchy + regional variation + historiography/source criticism + graded verdict	5-8 named units

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · 11

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Universal answer spine

HIGH

Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit · Visual 12

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compact visual logic for Terminology, timeline, memory hooks and answer toolkit.

TERMINOLOGY, TIMELINE, MEMORY HOOKS AND ANSWER TOOLKIT: VISUAL SPINE

DIRECT THESIS

- > define decline at the correct level
- > claim + named evidence + significance + limit
- > repeat across structural, political, regional and external dimensions
- > include counter-evidence on continuity/vitality
- > conclude with a weighted, two-level verdict

Read the arrows as analytical relationships, not as a claim that every region followed one identical sequence.

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified question: With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The Nizam of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
- The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
- Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.
- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only

HIGH**PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

D. 3 only

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** B, 1 and 2 only. Confidence: high. The repository routing verifies the question, but a locally readable UPSC key is unavailable.
- **Solved explanation**
 - Statement 1 is correct in the conventional successor-state genealogy: Arcot or the Carnatic operated under the Deccan/Hyderabad subordination before its nawabs acquired practical autonomy.
 - Statement 2 is correct: the Wodeyar kingdom of Mysore emerged from the political field of the Vijayanagara order.
 - Statement 3 is incorrect: Rohilla power in Rohilkhand grew from Afghan military settlement and weakening Mughal authority before Ahmad Shah Durrani's major Indian interventions; Durrani did not create it from his occupied territories.
 - Topic significance: the question tests whether eighteenth-century states are traced to their correct imperial or regional predecessor and whether later Afghan intervention is projected backward.

HIGH**PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor states · 3**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Why this earns marks: It evaluates each statement independently, supplies the political genealogy and marks the unavailable official key rather than presenting an inference as official.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified question: With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- A. Paragana - Sarkar - Suba
- B. Sarkar - Paragana - Suba
- C. Suba - Sarkar - Paragana
- D. Paragana - Suba - Sarkar
- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** A, Paragana - Sarkar - Suba. Confidence: high.
- **Solved explanation**

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchy · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A pargana grouped villages and formed the smaller revenue-administrative unit in this sequence.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- A sarkar grouped parganas.
- A subah was the larger province containing sarkars.
- Topic significance: the hierarchy is the territorial skeleton inherited in 1707. Decline occurred when provincial and local officers appropriated power inside this structure, not because the hierarchy instantly disappeared.
- **Why this earns marks:** It gives the exact ascending order and links the fact to the mechanism of provincial autonomy rather than treating it as isolated recall.

HIGH

PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verified adjacent question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (10 marks, 150 words)

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Routing note:** The direct owner is Modern History Topic 05. It is included here only as a verified bounded consequence because the 1707-1740s transition created a competitive multi-state field; it did not itself make Company victory inevitable.

- Model answer

- The Company's victories arose less from the ethnicity of its soldiers than from the organisation that converted them into a reliable fiscal-military force. Indian rulers inherited capable cavalry, artillery and revenue systems, but their armies were often composite contingents tied to chiefs. The Mughal experience at **Karnal (1739)** shows how divided command could neutralise numerical strength; Maratha confederate chiefs and successor states later faced similar coordination problems, though in different forms.

- By contrast, the Company combined regular drill, standardised infantry-artillery coordination and promotion within a single command. Its coastal bases and British naval network sustained supply, while London and Indian merchant credit financed long campaigns. Political intelligence, diplomacy and alliances divided opponents. After **Plassey (1757)** and especially the **Diwani (1765)**, Bengal revenue increasingly funded further war.

- Yet victory was contingent: Mysore, Marathas and Sikhs repeatedly imposed serious reverses. The decisive advantage was a cumulative organisation-credit-revenue system, not inherent European bravery or Indian military incapacity.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers "why" through six mechanisms, uses Karnal only as bounded background, names Plassey and Diwani as later fiscal turning points, and qualifies inevitability with Indian resistance.

HIGH

PYQ coverage conclusion

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The audited repository routes one directly relevant eighteenth-century successor-state Prelims question and one administrative-inheritance question. No direct GS-I Mains question confined to Mughal decline in 1707-1740s appears in the audited 2018-2025 route; the verified 2022 Company-armies question is therefore included only as an explicitly bounded bridge. No History Optional question is invented.

HIGH

PART III - HARD MCQ AND REMEDIAL LEARNING LOOPS

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 60 keys rotate strictly $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow D$ for fifteen complete cycles. Questions 1-48 are hard coverage questions; Questions 49-60 are remedials targeting predictable misconceptions.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which formulation best defines Mughal decline in this package?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Loss of enforceable central fiscal-military authority amid continuing institutions and legitimacy
- B. Immediate disappearance of the dynasty in 1707
- C. Uniform collapse of every regional economy
- D. Replacement of Persian administration by Company rule in 1719

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Decline is level-specific: central command contracted while the dynasty, revenue idiom and cultural order persisted.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not equate imperial contraction with instant civilisational collapse.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 02 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which sequence correctly describes the administrative scale from smaller to larger?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Subah → pargana → sarkar
- B. Pargana → sarkar → subah
- C. Sarkar → subah → pargana
- D. Pargana → subah → sarkar

- **Answer: B**

- **Explanation:** A pargana grouped villages, a sarkar grouped parganas and a subah was the larger province.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 02 · 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: UPSC often reverses the middle and upper units.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 03 · 1**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Be-jagiri most precisely referred to:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Confiscation of all zamindari rights
- B. Permanent hereditary ownership of crown land
- C. Lack or delay of a suitable jagir for a claimant
- D. A Maratha levy on Mughal provinces

- **Answer: C**

- **Explanation:** Be-jagiri identifies assignment scarcity or delay within the mansab-jagir system.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 03 · 2**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: It is not a general word for corruption.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the strongest qualification to a single-cause 'weak successors' thesis?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every post-1707 emperor was militarily stronger than Aurangzeb
- B. Succession ceased to matter after Bahadur Shah
- C. Provincial governors possessed no independent revenue base
- D. Capable nobles existed, but incentives directed their capacity into factional and regional power
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Zulfiqar Khan, the Sayyids, Nizam-ul-Mulk and Murshid Quli Khan show that talent survived while institutional alignment failed.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not replace a ruler-only thesis with a nobles-only thesis.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bahadur Shah I's Deccan policy is best described as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Partial conciliation that recognised sardeshmukhi but failed to settle chauth and Maratha succession
- B. Full recognition of Tarabai as sole Maratha ruler
- C. Total military destruction of Maratha power
- D. Transfer of Hyderabad to the English Company
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** His policy tried accommodation but left Shahu-Tarabai rivalry and fiscal claims unresolved.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Partial concessions are not the same as a durable settlement.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Zulfiqar Khan's importance lies primarily in:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Founding the state of Bengal
- B. Showing both the administrative potential and coalition danger of a powerful wazir
- C. Defeating Nadir Shah at Karnal
- D. Abolishing the mansabdari system
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** He pursued conciliation and fiscal restraint, but emperor and nobles feared an over-mighty minister.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid reducing his career to Jahandar Shah's court anecdotes.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Sayyid Brothers' conflict with Farrukhsiyar centred most directly on:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A doctrinal dispute over Sufi orders alone
- B. Whether Persian should replace Turkish
- C. Control of appointments, seal, jagirs, army and provincial resources
- D. Company annexation of Bengal
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The struggle concerned the operational levers of sovereignty.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Religious slogans used later by opponents do not define the original institutional dispute.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about the Sayyid Brothers is incorrect?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. They helped place Farrukhsiyar on the throne
- B. They pursued conciliation with Rajputs, Jats and Marathas
- C. Their deposition of Farrukhsiyar damaged monarchical prestige
- D. They formally abolished the Mughal dynasty and founded their own royal house
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** They remained kingmakers within the Timurid framework and never founded a Sayyid imperial dynasty.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Kingmaker does not mean emperor.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 1718-19 Maratha settlement associated with the Sayyids sought to:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Exchange recognition of Shahu's claims and fiscal rights for service and political support
- B. End all Maratha collection outside the swarajya
- C. Make Nizam-ul-Mulk Peshwa
- D. Transfer Bengal customs to the Marathas
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** The settlement tried to convert conflict into regulated fiscal-military partnership.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Legal recognition did not guarantee uniform implementation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why was Muhammad Shah's early reign still a possible recovery moment?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The jagirdari system had already been abolished
- B. Chronological stability, continuing prestige and surviving military-administrative resources remained
- C. Nadir Shah had become a Mughal ally
- D. All provinces resumed full remittance
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The early 1720s retained resources that a coherent centre might have mobilised.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Recovery was possible, not assured.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nizam-ul-Mulk's move to the Deccan in 1724 is best understood as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A nationalist declaration against all Mughal culture
- B. An English-sponsored conquest of Hyderabad
- C. Conversion of imperial office and military networks into practical regional autonomy
- D. A complete rejection of coins and khutba in the emperor's name
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Hyderabad retained imperial forms while command and revenue became regional.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Autonomy is not identical to formal modern independence.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pairing is correctly matched?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Murshid Quli Khan - foundation of Hyderabad
- B. Nizam-ul-Mulk - foundation of Bengal
- C. Churaman - foundation of the Nizamat of Arcot
- D. Saadat Khan - foundation of autonomous Awadh

- **Answer: D**

- **Explanation:** Saadat Khan was appointed to Awadh in 1722 and built its semi-autonomous order.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Successor-state founders are a frequent attribution trap.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Turani, Irani, Afghan and Hindustani labels should be treated as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Recruitment and affinity networks within fluid coalitions
- B. Fixed modern political parties with permanent manifestos
- C. Religious sects with no connection to office
- D. Revenue units below the pargana

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Origin and kinship mattered, but alliances shifted around office, jagirs and survival.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not harden flexible court blocs into permanent ethnic parties.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which mechanism most directly links jagir pressure to military weakness?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Jagirdars were legally forbidden to employ cavalry
- B. Inadequate yields and arrears encouraged mansabdars to maintain fewer troops than sanctioned
- C. Khalisa revenue automatically went to Maratha forts
- D. All artillery was owned by zamindars
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The service bargain failed when paper rank and real fiscal support diverged.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A large mansab did not guarantee a field-ready contingent.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The jama-hasil gap refers to the difference between:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cavalry rank and infantry rank
- B. Chauth and sardeshmukhi
- C. Assessed revenue and revenue actually realised
- D. Imperial coin and provincial coin
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Paper assessment could exceed collection because of resistance, devastation or administrative weakness.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse assessment with cash available to the army.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

John F. Richards's qualification to a simple jagir-shortage thesis stresses that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No jagirdari problem existed anywhere
- B. Only religious policy mattered
- C. Bengal had ceased cultivation by 1700
- D. Allocation choices and the treatment of Deccan khalisa could make the crisis partly policy-produced
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Resources, allocation and realisation must be distinguished.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A qualification is not a total rejection of fiscal crisis.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Ijara created which recurring risk?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A contractor's incentive to extract above the fixed payment promised to government
- B. Automatic conversion of peasants into mansabdars
- C. A ban on cash revenue
- D. Permanent restoration of village autonomy
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Revenue farming inserted cash-rich intermediaries whose profit could intensify pressure.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It could coexist with commercial sophistication and coercion.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement best captures zamindars in the Mughal order?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. They were salaried clerks without local ties
- B. They were local right-holders and armed intermediaries whose cooperation or resistance shaped collection
- C. They were identical to European freehold landlords
- D. They had no role in peasant mobilisation
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Zamindars linked the state to locality and could convert that position into rebellion or rule.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both 'mere collector' and 'absolute owner'.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The most balanced reading of peasant participation in Jat or Sikh assertion is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Religion alone explains every participant
- B. Peasants acted without any intermediaries
- C. Agrarian grievance became durable through local leadership, identity, forts and armed organisation
- D. Revenue pressure played no role
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Material grievance and political organisation worked together.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not erase either agrarian structure or identity.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which claim about eighteenth-century agriculture is safest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cultivation stopped throughout India after 1707
- B. Every region experienced equal prosperity
- C. Only European capital financed agriculture
- D. Severe extraction and resistance coexisted with expansion and monetisation in some regions

- **Answer: D**

- **Explanation:** Regional variation is essential to the decline-versus-transition debate.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not convert a regional example into an all-India total.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Chauth is best described as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A Maratha claim conventionally represented as one-fourth of assessed revenue
- B. A Mughal tax on non-Muslims
- C. A ten per cent imperial customs duty
- D. The salary rank of a mansabdar

- **Answer: A**

- **Explanation:** Chauth was a fiscal-political claim imposed or negotiated in territories beyond the core swarajya.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It was not simply a village land-revenue rate.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Sardeshmukhi is conventionally distinguished from chauth as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A synonym for imperial khalisa
- B. An additional ten per cent claim linked to superior regional right
- C. A Sikh levy in Punjab
- D. A European sea customs pass
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The two Maratha claims had distinct conventional bases even when bargained together.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not reverse the quarter and ten-per-cent associations.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why did the 1718-19 Maratha settlement not end Deccan conflict?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The settlement contained no fiscal provisions
- B. Shahu immediately abolished the Peshwa's office
- C. Competing Maratha, Mughal and Nizam interests made legal recognition difficult to enforce
- D. The Deccan had no local forts or sardars
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** A sanad could frame rights but not eliminate rival collectors and political centres.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Documentary grant is not uniform implementation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Baji Rao I's wider significance within this topic is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He led Nadir Shah's Persian army
- B. He founded Awadh in 1722
- C. He restored Mughal control over Punjab
- D. He shifted Maratha strategy toward sustained expansion into Malwa, Gujarat and north Indian politics
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Maratha pressure moved from Deccan survival to wider fiscal and political reach.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Reach should not be equated with uniform territorial administration.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Churaman is associated with:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Jat power in the Agra-Mathura region
- B. Sikh mobilisation at Lohgarh
- C. Hyderabad's foundation
- D. Persian victory at Karnal
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Churaman's networks illustrate fortified zamindari and negotiated resistance.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse Jat and Sikh leaders.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Banda Bahadur's movement is important because it:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Created the twelve misls after 1765 within this period
- B. Combined Sikh political-religious mobilisation with a major challenge to Mughal authority in Punjab
- C. Served as Nadir Shah's frontier army
- D. Established Bengal's revenue administration
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The movement survived the limits of Bahadur Shah's campaigning even though later Sikh phases lay beyond the core period.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not begin Sikh political history with Ranjit Singh.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about Rajput politics is most accurate?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. All Rajput houses formed one permanent anti-Mughal coalition
- B. Rajputs ceased receiving mansabs after 1707
- C. Rajput rulers could seek high Mughal office while bargaining for regional autonomy
- D. Their conflicts were purely religious
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Jai Singh and Ajit Singh demonstrate simultaneous imperial participation and regional assertion.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid binary loyalist/rebel labels.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The strongest common feature of Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad was:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Formal republican constitutions
- B. Complete abolition of Persian administration
- C. Direct creation by Ahmad Shah Durrani
- D. Provincial office converted into hereditary autonomy while Mughal legitimacy was retained
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** All three were successor states, but each rested on a distinct regional base.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Common origin does not make their later institutions identical.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal order depended significantly on:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Tight revenue collection, major zamindars and merchant-bankers
- B. Maratha control of the Bengal mint
- C. Abolition of land revenue
- D. Direct annual election by village councils
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Provincial fiscal capacity rested on collaboration with landed and financial elites.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Efficient collection could still be socially coercive.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Jagat Seth house illustrates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The disappearance of Indian bankers before Plassey
- B. The political importance of credit, remittance and mint-linked finance in Bengal
- C. A Sikh misl in Punjab
- D. A Mughal artillery corps
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Bankers were not decorative merchants; they connected revenue, government and political coalition.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Commercial vitality did not guarantee political neutrality.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which best describes Saadat Khan's relation to Delhi?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He immediately rejected every Mughal title
- B. He ruled Bengal as Murshid Quli's deputy
- C. He built Awadh autonomy while continuing to seek imperial office and confirmation
- D. He became Peshwa after Baji Rao
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Provincial state-building and court ambition remained intertwined.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not project later complete separation backward.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hyderabad's continued use of the emperor's name on coins and in khutba indicates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Direct daily taxation by Delhi
- B. Absence of any regional autonomy
- C. Conversion of Hyderabad into a European colony
- D. Layered sovereignty and the continuing value of Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Symbolic recognition coexisted with practical independence in war, appointment and revenue.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Symbols are politically real but not proof of direct control.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement correctly distinguishes the three successor states?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Bengal was strongly commercial-fiscal, Awadh a Ganga-plain military-revenue state, Hyderabad a contested Deccan polity
- B. They had identical elite coalitions and geography
- C. Only Awadh retained Mughal forms
- D. All three were founded after Nadir Shah's death
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Common Mughal ancestry produced different regional trajectories.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: A matrix answer earns more than a generic list.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is the phrase 'political vacuum' inadequate?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No territory changed political hands
- B. Regional states, zamindars, Marathas and financiers exercised organised power as Delhi weakened
- C. The emperor maintained full coercive control
- D. European companies withdrew from India
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Power was redistributed, not removed from society.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Rejecting 'vacuum' does not deny violent instability.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was a central military weakness of the later Mughal host?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Complete absence of artillery
- B. Legal prohibition on cavalry
- C. Composite contingents and factional commanders lacked reliable unified coordination
- D. Dependence solely on European infantry
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Karnal shows how divided leadership nullified considerable resources.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not use a crude technology-only explanation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A high mansab in 1739 did not necessarily reveal:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The holder's nominal rank
- B. A recognised service status
- C. A claim on imperial patronage
- D. The number of paid, equipped and deployable soldiers actually present
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Fiscal shortfalls and inspection weakness separated paper strength from battlefield strength.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Nominal figures should not be treated as headcounts.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nadir Shah's comparative military advantage is best stated as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Unified command, mobility, disciplined fire and flexible use of artillery
- B. Exclusive possession of all gunpowder technology
- C. Naval blockade of Delhi
- D. Support from a united Mughal nobility
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** The Mughals had guns; Nadir integrated force and decision more effectively.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid 'modern guns versus medieval swords'.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The northwest frontier failed before Karnal mainly because:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Kabul had never been connected to Mughal strategy
- B. Warnings, diplomacy, reinforcement and command were not converted into a coherent defensive system
- C. Nadir approached through Bengal
- D. The Marathas controlled Qandahar
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The court received embassies and reports but lacked timely institutional response.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Information alone is not preparedness.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Farukhsiyar's 1717 farman to the English Company primarily concerned:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Transfer of Bengal sovereignty to the Company
- B. Appointment of a Company governor of Awadh
- C. Commercial privileges in Bengal, later contested through passes and private trade
- D. Military conquest of Hyderabad
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The farman was a legal-commercial privilege with later political consequences.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not convert trade privilege into territorial grant.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which economic statement is most defensible?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every rupee not sent to Delhi disappeared from circulation
- B. Bengal trade ended in 1717
- C. Delhi had no commerce after 1739
- D. Decline in imperial remittance could coexist with stronger regional treasuries and markets
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Resources were redistributed toward regions, though social costs and war remained.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Centre and region must be analysed separately.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Satish Chandra's caution about Nadir Shah's booty is used to show that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Famous totals should not be treated as proof of immediate all-India economic collapse
- B. No treasure was removed from Delhi
- C. The invasion had no fiscal effect
- D. The Peacock Throne remained in the Diwan-i-Khas
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Plunder was severe, but the scale and long-term economic interpretation require qualification.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both exaggeration and minimisation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Muhammad Shah's patronage of music and painting demonstrates:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Cultural patronage automatically restored provincial remittance
- B. Cultural vitality could coexist with political and military contraction
- C. Court music caused the jagirdari crisis
- D. Regional courts stopped supporting artists
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Culture is an independent evidentiary dimension, not a proxy for governance.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not moralise aesthetic life into causation.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Dargah Quli Khan's Muraqqa-i Dehli is especially useful for:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Exact all-India peasant income statistics
- B. Official Persian casualty totals at Karnal
- C. Urban and courtly life in Muhammad Shah's Delhi
- D. The legal text of the 1717 farman
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** It supplies an urban social view that complements political chronicles.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Delhi-centred observation cannot represent every region.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was a plausible motive for Nadir Shah's invasion?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A verified invitation from Nizam and Saadat Khan
- B. A plan to establish permanent Persian rule over Bengal
- C. A Sikh request to conquer Delhi
- D. Resources for a war-making Persian state combined with Mughal frontier weakness
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Fiscal-military motive, wealth and opportunity explain more than unsupported invitation stories.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Satish Chandra notes no documentary proof of the invitation claim.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The conventional modern date of the Battle of Karnal is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. 24 February 1739
- B. 13 January 1719
- C. 24 February 1748
- D. 13 March 1757
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Modern reference works conventionally date Karnal to 24 February 1739.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not confuse Karnal with the first Durrani invasion in 1748.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Karnal is best interpreted as:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The origin of every Mughal problem
- B. An external battlefield test that exposed pre-existing fiscal and command weakness
- C. A Maratha victory over Nadir Shah
- D. The formal end of the Mughal dynasty
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The invasion accelerated and publicised decline already visible in factions and regions.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Event and structural cause must be separated.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which claim about the Delhi massacre is methodologically safest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. No civilian violence occurred
- B. Every chronicle gives the same number
- C. The massacre occurred, but a single precise casualty total should not be asserted as settled
- D. The event was invented by Company records
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** Catastrophe is certain; totals vary across rhetorical and retrospective sources.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Numerical restraint is evidence discipline, not denial.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Nadir Shah's settlement with Muhammad Shah did which of the following?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Annexed the whole Gangetic plain to Persia
- B. Abolished the Mughal dynasty
- C. Installed the Sayyid Brothers as rulers
- D. Left Muhammad Shah on the throne while transferring wealth and frontier territories west of the Indus
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Nadir extracted and withdrew rather than constructing Persian government over north India.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Plunder and annexation west of the Indus are distinct from ruling Delhi.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which was not a consequence of 1739?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Immediate uniform destruction of all Indian trade and urban life
- B. Severe loss of imperial prestige
- C. Greater frontier exposure
- D. Encouragement to provincial and local assertion
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Delhi and regional commerce showed resilience even after a severe political-fiscal shock.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Do not infer all-India collapse from capital-city catastrophe.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The first Durrani invasion in 1748 is used here only to show:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The root cause of the 1707 succession war
- B. A bounded frontier consequence after Nadir's death and the continued possibility of Mughal resistance
- C. The creation of Rohilkhand
- D. The end of Maratha power in the Deccan
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** It lies at the edge of scope and should not displace the 1707-1739 explanation.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Keep later Afghan history bounded.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 51 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which causal ordering is strongest?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Culture declined, therefore jagirs disappeared
- B. Nadir invaded, therefore Aurangzeb fought in the Deccan
- C. Fiscal strain weakened service; weak service reduced collection; lower collection intensified faction and autonomy
- D. Company trade ended, therefore Bengal became rich
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The decline operated through a self-reinforcing fiscal-political loop.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 51 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Good answers explain mechanisms, not just list factors.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 52 · 1****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which statement best captures Mughal continuity?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Every successor state abolished mansabs immediately
- B. Persian ceased to be used after 1707
- C. The khutba lost all political meaning
- D. Regional powers appropriated imperial titles, documents and revenue practices even as Delhi lost command
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Continuity lowered the legitimacy cost of regional state formation.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 52 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Institutional survival does not mean unchanged operation.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly are most useful for arguing that:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The eighteenth century involved regional reordering, commercial networks and redistributed power
- B. The Mughal centre remained fully sovereign
- C. Agrarian pressure never existed
- D. Nadir Shah created Bengal's banking system
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Revisionist work corrects a total-dark-age narrative.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: It must be balanced against warfare and unequal social costs.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Jadunath Sarkar's older interpretation is most often associated with:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. A denial that emperors mattered
- B. Aurangzeb-centred, personality, moral and political decline
- C. The portfolio-capital thesis
- D. The claim that jagirs never existed
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** The older view supplies political narrative but risks moral and communal reduction.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Name the interpretation and then qualify it.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the best historiographical synthesis?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Only moral decay mattered
- B. No meaningful decline occurred at any level
- C. Central fiscal-military decline plus uneven regional state formation and continuing economic-cultural vitality
- D. Every region followed the same agrarian trajectory
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** A two-level, regionally qualified verdict incorporates the strongest evidence.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Balance does not mean treating every thesis as equally explanatory.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 56 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

A coin in Muhammad Shah's name issued within a successor state most directly proves:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. Daily administrative control by Delhi
- B. Absence of regional taxation
- C. The emperor's personal presence at the mint
- D. A public claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer: D**
- **Explanation:** Numismatic titlature reveals acknowledged sovereignty and political language.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 56 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Material symbols require an implementation limit.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57 · 1****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Why could Mughal legitimacy survive military contraction?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. It remained a recognised language for title, succession, revenue rights and arbitration
- B. Regional rulers had no armies
- C. The emperor controlled every provincial treasury
- D. European companies prohibited local coins
- **Answer: A**
- **Explanation:** Existing institutions made imperial sanction useful even to autonomous powers.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ 57 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Symbolic power can have practical political value.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which answer line is strongest for Aurangzeb's responsibility?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. He alone caused every event through religious policy
- B. His Deccan and coalition choices aggravated structural strain, but post-1707 institutions and actors determined the trajectory
- C. He had no role because he died in 1707
- D. His empire had already ceased to exist before his death
- **Answer: B**
- **Explanation:** Balanced causation distinguishes inherited strain from later mechanisms.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58 · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Trap logic: Avoid both exoneration and total blame.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59 · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about 'dark age' is most defensible?

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. It is a precise statistical category
- B. It proves culture disappeared
- C. It captures real imperial and social disruption but fails as an all-region description
- D. It is fully refuted by one prosperous merchant
- **Answer: C**
- **Explanation:** The period was neither uniform collapse nor uncomplicated regional prosperity.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59 · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Use levels, regions and social groups.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60 · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The most useful final verdict on Nadir Shah is:

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- A. The sole structural cause
- B. Economically irrelevant
- C. Founder of a permanent Persian Mughal dynasty
- D. Decisive in timing and prestige, secondary to deeper causes of decline

- **Answer:** D

- **Explanation:** His invasion transformed perception and frontier security but depended on prior weakness.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60 · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Trap logic: Accelerant and revealer are not euphemisms for no impact.

OPTIONS, ANSWER AND EXPLANATION

- **Remedial target:** Correct the named misconception before returning to the comparative and source-based questions.

HIGH

Mains 10M-1 - Distinguish between decline, decentralisation and regionalisation in the Mughal context after 1707.GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The terms identify different levels of the same transition. **Decline** refers to the loss of enforceable authority at Delhi: repeated succession struggles, the Sayyids' deposition of Farrukhsiyar in 1719 and divided command at Karnal in 1739 show that the emperor could no longer arbitrate elites or defend the frontier.

- **Decentralisation** describes the movement of revenue and appointment power from the centre to provinces. Murshid Quli Khan in Bengal, Saadat Khan in Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk in Hyderabad retained Mughal offices but made collection, military command and succession increasingly regional.

- **Regionalisation** goes further: provincial governors, zamindars, bankers and military groups formed durable political arenas. Bengal's large zamindars and Jagat Seth finance, Maratha chauth networks, and Jat-Sikh mobilisation reveal new coalitions below Delhi.

- The processes overlapped but were not identical. Coin, khutba, Persian chancery and imperial confirmation survived, so political force shifted before Mughal legitimacy disappeared. The period was therefore decline at the centre, decentralisation of functions and uneven regionalisation of power.

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines all three terms, supplies three distinct evidence clusters, shows overlap without collapsing categories and ends with a precise two-level verdict.

HIGH

Mains 10M-2 - Were the Sayyid Brothers merely destroyers of Mughal authority? Examine.

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The Sayyid Brothers were both products and accelerants of the Mughal crisis, not merely destroyers. Abdullah Khan and Husain Ali raised Farrukhsiyar in 1713 because succession already depended on armed noble coalitions. Their conflict with him concerned the imperial seal, appointments, jagirs and Deccan resources - the substance of sovereignty.

- They also attempted repair. Satish Chandra records their abolition of jizya and pilgrim taxes, conciliation of Jai Singh, Ajit Singh and Churaman, and the 1718-19 settlement that exchanged recognition of Shahu's fiscal claims for Maratha support. These were efforts to widen the ruling coalition.

- Yet their deposition and killing of Farrukhsiyar in 1719 made Timurid monarchy visibly dependent on kingmakers. Rapid enthronements and patronage promises intensified jagir factionalism; opponents could then rally around dynasty, old nobility and religion. Husain Ali's assassination and Abdullah's defeat in 1720 ended their power, not the underlying crisis.

- Thus the Sayyids administered creatively under structural pressure, but their coercive kingmaking deepened the loss of monarchical authority.

- **Why this earns marks:** It directly tests the word 'merely', balances policies against consequences, names offices, rulers and settlements, and distinguishes symptom from agency.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - Explain why the invasion of Nadir Shah was an exposure rather than the origin of Mughal decline.

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 150 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Nadir Shah's invasion was possible because the imperial system had already weakened. Before 1739, Farrukhsiyar had been deposed by noble kingmakers; Nizam-ul-Mulk had converted Deccan office into Hyderabad autonomy in 1724; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and mansabdars often failed to maintain full contingents because jagir yields and cash were unreliable.

- The frontier reproduced this failure. Delhi did not turn Nadir's repeated embassies or the fall of Qandahar and Kabul into timely reinforcement. At **Karnal, 24 February 1739**, Muhammad Shah's leading nobles disputed command. Saadat Khan engaged without an integrated plan, Khan-i-Dauran was mortally wounded, and Nadir's unified mobile force prevailed.

- The invasion nevertheless accelerated decline. Delhi suffered massacre and plunder; the emperor ceded territories west of the Indus; prestige collapsed; and regional actors saw that the centre could not protect itself. But Muhammad Shah remained emperor, Delhi recovered commercial life and Mughal legitimacy survived.

- Karnal was therefore an X-ray of a prior fiscal-command crisis and a severe new blow, not its original disease.

- **Why this earns marks:** It proves pre-existing weakness with four named units, explains Karnal's mechanism, gives real consequences and avoids minimising the invasion.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Critically examine the jagirdari-agrarian crisis as an explanation of Mughal decline. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The jagirdari-agrarian thesis is powerful because it links elite politics, rural extraction and military weakness, but it must be regionally qualified.

- **Institutional mechanism:** Satish Chandra argues that mansab and salary claims outgrew dependable assignments. *Be-jagiri*, competition for productive jagirs and the diversion of khalisa weakened the centre's cash. The **jama-hasil** gap meant that paper assessment did not equal realised revenue.

- **Rural transmission:** Frequent transfer encouraged short-term extraction. Bipan Chandra notes the spread of **ijara**, under which contractors promised a fixed sum and sought profit from cultivators. Irfan Habib connects high surplus demand to peasant flight, arrears and zamindar-led Jat, Sikh and other resistance.

- **Military consequence:** Nobles with inadequate income did not maintain full contingents. Thus fiscal weakness reduced coercion; weaker coercion further reduced collection. Court parties then recruited followers by promising ranks and jagirs, as in the Farrukhsiyar-Sayyid conflict.

- **Qualifications:** John F. Richards asks whether Deccan revenues and khalisa choices made part of the scarcity policy-produced. Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly point to agrarian growth, monetisation, bankers and regional states, showing that resources were redistributed rather than universally destroyed. Bengal's strong collection under Murshid Quli Khan is counter-evidence to an all-India production collapse, although it could burden smaller zamindars and peasants.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Critically examine the jagirdari-agrarian crisis as an explanation of Mughal decline. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Therefore the crisis is best treated as a variable mechanism: assignment, extraction and service diverged, but the degree and social outcome differed across regions.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines the mechanism, uses Chandra, Habib, Richards and revisionist counter-evidence, connects fiscal and military outcomes and gives a qualified rather than absolute verdict.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - The Mughal successor states represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Discuss with reference to Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS**- Model answer**

- Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad did not emerge through one clean declaration of independence. They converted Mughal provincial office into hereditary regional authority while preserving the imperial idiom.

- **Bengal:** Murshid Quli Khan, confirmed governor in 1717, tightened survey and collection through powerful zamindars, transferred troublesome jagirdars and relied on merchant-bankers. Remittance and formal allegiance initially continued, but appointments and dynastic succession became provincial. The Jagat Seth house's later role in treasury and mint shows a regional fiscal coalition.

- **Awadh:** Saadat Khan, appointed in 1722, subdued local rajas and expanded provincial command. Yet he still sought imperial office. Safdar Jung's succession after 1739-40 required gifts and confirmation, proving that autonomy and Timurid sanction reinforced each other.

- **Hyderabad:** Nizam-ul-Mulk left the wizarat and defeated Mubariz Khan in 1724. He conducted war, appointment and revenue regionally, while coins, khutba and mansab vocabulary retained Muhammad Shah's sovereignty. Deccan merchants, revenue intermediaries and military elites gave the state its distinct base.

- The states also differed: Bengal was a rich agrarian-commercial province, Awadh a middle-Ganga military-revenue arena and Hyderabad a multi-centred Deccan polity constrained by Marathas and local chiefs.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - The Mughal successor states represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Discuss with reference to Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Thus Mughal administrative forms reduced the cost of regional state-building, while control over revenue and force moved decisively away from Delhi.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It compares three states through the same analytical headings, supplies named fiscal and legitimacy evidence, states regional differences and answers both continuity and autonomy.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - How far was Aurangzeb responsible for the decline of the Mughal Empire? · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 250 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Aurangzeb was substantially responsible for intensifying the empire's constraints, but he cannot be made the single cause of a decline worked out after 1707.

- **Real responsibility:** The long Deccan commitment absorbed treasury and troops, added difficult territories and failed to extinguish Maratha mobility. Incorporating Deccani and Maratha entrants increased claims on mansabs and jagirs. The emperor's prolonged southern presence weakened supervision of the north and northwest. Conflict over Marwar damaged a Rajput alliance central to Mughal power; jizya and some temple policies narrowed legitimacy in places.

- **Necessary qualification:** Bipan Chandra notes that administration, army and dynastic prestige remained substantial at Aurangzeb's death. Religious measures were reversed: Bahadur Shah and later the Sayyids restored broad accommodation, while Hindu and Muslim nobles repeatedly allied across faith for office and revenue.

- **Post-1707 mechanisms:** Succession wars killed commanders and made noble coalitions decisive. The Sayyids deposed Farrukhsiyar; Nizam-ul-Mulk regionalised Deccan power; jagir and agrarian pressures weakened contingents; Bengal and Awadh retained revenue; and Muhammad Shah's nobles failed to coordinate at Karnal.

- Jadunath Sarkar's ruler-centred reading therefore identifies important agency but becomes inadequate when communal or moral blame replaces institutional evidence. Satish Chandra's jagirdari-Deccan synthesis better explains transmission.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - How far was Aurangzeb responsible for the decline of the Mughal Empire? · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Aurangzeb aggravated the inheritance; later fiscal, political and regional choices converted strain into systemic decline.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers 'how far' with concession, qualification and ranking; uses Deccan, Rajput, jizya, Sayyids, successor states and Karnal; and attributes historiography accurately.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Why did Mughal central authority decline between 1707 and the 1740s? Present a weighted multi-causal explanation. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Mughal central authority declined because the fiscal-military contract that joined emperor, nobility, province and countryside ceased to reproduce revenue, service and obedience. Weak rulers and invasion mattered, but they operated through a deeper interactive crisis.

- **1. Inherited over-extension:** Aurangzeb left a formidable empire, yet the long Deccan war had tied down forces, complicated jagir allocation and failed to eliminate Maratha mobility. Rajput and Punjab difficulties and weakened northwest attention added strain. This was a difficult inheritance, not inevitable collapse.

- **2. Succession and arbitration:** With no fixed succession rule, Jajau in 1707 and the contests after Bahadur Shah's death consumed soldiers and made the throne dependent on noble coalitions. Farrukhsiyar's deposition in 1719 showed that kingmakers could control monarchy; rapid enthronements weakened dynastic awe.

- **3. Jagirdari-fiscal mechanism:** Satish Chandra's *be-jagiri* thesis links a growing body of claimants to inadequate or low-yield assignments. Jama exceeded hasil, khalisa was granted away and frequent transfer promoted short-term extraction. Under ijara, contractors pressed cultivators for profit. Nobles in arrears maintained incomplete contingents.

- **4. Agrarian and regional feedback:** Irfan Habib connects extraction to peasant and zamindar resistance. Jats, Sikhs, Bundelas and local chiefs withheld revenue and fortified power. Revisionist evidence adds that agrarian growth, bankers and monetisation could strengthen regions: Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal was fiscally vigorous even as Delhi lost remittance.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Why did Mughal central authority decline between 1707 and the 1740s? Present a weighted multi-causal explanation. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

5. Provincial and Maratha reordering: Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad converted office into autonomy while retaining imperial legitimacy. Maratha chauth and sardeshmukhi moved from contested exaction to imperial bargaining in 1718-19 and wider expansion under Baji Rao.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- **6. Military-command failure:** The army retained artillery and numbers, but paper mansabs, arrears, slow logistics and factional command reduced usable strength. At Karnal in 1739, divided Mughal action faced Nadir's integrated mobility and fire discipline.

- **7. External shock:** Nadir's victory, the Delhi massacre, plunder and loss west of the Indus devastated prestige and frontier security. Yet regional autonomy and fiscal weakness clearly predated him.

- The causal order is therefore weighted: fiscal-military and political structures formed the core; rural and regional movements amplified them; military underperformance transmitted them; Nadir determined the dramatic timing and visibility of collapse. Mughal legitimacy and institutions survived, so the outcome was central decline with uneven regional transition, not instant disappearance.

- **Why this earns marks:** It gives a ranked mechanism rather than a list, uses more than eight named evidence units, separates inherited strain from post-1707 transmission, integrates revisionist counter-evidence and ends with a level-specific verdict.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Was the eighteenth century in India a 'dark age' of decline or an age of regional transformation? Critically discuss with reference to 1707-1740s. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- Neither label is sufficient alone. The period was a darkening of Mughal central fiscal-military capacity and, simultaneously, an uneven transformation of political and economic power toward regions.

- **Evidence for decline:** Succession contests after 1707 destroyed continuity and empowered factions. Farrukhsiyar's deposition by the Sayyids in 1719 eroded monarchical prestige. Jagir competition, jama-hasil gaps and ijara shifted pressure toward cultivators; Jat, Sikh and zamindar resistance disrupted revenue. Provincial remittance weakened, mansabdars under-maintained contingents and Nadir Shah's victory at Karnal in 1739 culminated in massacre, plunder and frontier loss.

- Older narratives associated with Jadunath Sarkar read these developments through Aurangzeb, weak successors and moral-political decay. They preserve chronology and agency but risk treating court conduct and religious policy as complete causation.

- **Evidence for transformation:** Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan created a strong revenue order supported by large zamindars and bankers. Saadat Khan's Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk's Hyderabad retained Mughal titles, coins, khutba and administration while regionalising force and revenue. Maratha networks converted chauth and sardeshmukhi into a wide political system; Jats and Sikhs built durable local mobilisation.

- Muzaffar Alam and C.A. Bayly therefore stress decentralisation, regional politics, credit and "portfolio" resources. Cultural evidence strengthens the case: Dargah Quli Khan's Delhi, Muhammad Shah's music and painting, and the movement of Persianate forms to regional courts contradict total civilisational collapse. Satish Chandra even cautions that the famous economic effect of Nadir's booty is often overstated.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Was the eighteenth century in India a 'dark age' of decline or an age of regional transformation? Critically discuss with reference to 1707-1740s. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Social and regional qualification: Regional vitality could rest on coercive collection. Murshid Quli's efficient Bengal disadvantaged smaller zamindars; warfare and revenue farming exposed peasants and artisans. Delhi's recovery cannot represent every devastated corridor.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- The best synthesis is a two-level history: the imperial centre declined catastrophically, while political authority, commerce and culture were reorganised through regions with unequal benefits and costs. "Transition" is the broader category; "decline" remains indispensable for Delhi's lost capacity.

- **Why this earns marks:** It constructs and tests both sides with political, fiscal, regional, economic and cultural evidence; names historiographical positions; adds social costs; and delivers a non-evasive critical verdict.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - Analyse the relationship between military weakness, regional autonomy and the survival of Mughal legitimacy in the early eighteenth century. · 1

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Directive and limit: Answer in approximately 350 words. Use a direct thesis, evidence-linked analysis, one qualification and a reasoned verdict.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Model answer

- The apparent paradox of the early eighteenth century is that Mughal military enforcement contracted while Mughal legitimacy remained the preferred language of new power. The two developments were connected.

- **Military weakness:** The mansab system mobilised composite noble contingents, not one uniformly drilled standing army. Jagir arrears and weak inspection meant that sanctioned rank exceeded deployable troops. Heavy artillery, large camps and capable cavalry remained, but factional commanders disputed precedence and plan. At Karnal in 1739, Saadat Khan's uncoordinated engagement, Khan-i-Dauran's fatal intervention and Nizam-ul-Mulk's constrained role allowed Nadir Shah's unified mobile force to defeat a larger host.

- **Regional autonomy as response:** Where Delhi could not guarantee assignment, protection or arbitration, powerful office-holders internalised resources. Murshid Quli Khan made Bengal's revenue administration provincial; Saadat Khan subdued Awadh's chiefs; Nizam-ul-Mulk transformed the Deccan viceroyalty into Hyderabad after 1724. Marathas extracted chauth and sardeshmukhi, while Jats, Sikhs and zamindars built armed local networks. Military labour and finance followed reliable regional patrons.

- **Why legitimacy survived:** None of these actors operated in an institutional vacuum. The Timurid emperor could still grant mansabs, titles, farmans and sanads that rival claimants recognised. Hyderabad retained coin and khutba in the emperor's name; Safdar Jung sought confirmation in Awadh; Maratha leaders sought imperial documentary recognition; the English Company relied on Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman.

- **Significance:** Mughal forms reduced the legitimacy cost of decentralisation. A governor could exercise independent war and taxation while presenting succession as lawful continuity. Control of the emperor therefore remained valuable even after he lost provincial command.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - Analyse the relationship between military weakness, regional autonomy and the survival of Mughal legitimacy in the early eighteenth century. · 2

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Limit: Symbols were not mere fiction, but neither did they restore cash or battlefield coordination. Their practical effect depended on recognition by nobles, zamindars, merchants and rival states.

EVIDENCE-LINKED ANALYSIS

- Thus military weakness shifted protection and patronage to regions, while the shared Mughal administrative-cultural order enabled that shift to occur without an immediate formal rupture. Force regionalised faster than legitimacy.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the relationship rather than three separate themes, uses Karnal, three successor states, Marathas and documentary/numismatic evidence, and distinguishes practical symbolic power from direct control.

HIGH

REGISTER 01 - Scope and key termsGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 01 - SCOPE AND KEY TERMS - REVISION CORE**

Core window: 1707-1740s; late-Aurangzeb background only where causal; post-1748 developments only as bounded consequence.

REGISTER 01 - SCOPE AND KEY TERMS - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Decline = loss of enforceable central fiscal-military authority.
- Decentralisation = powers and revenues move from Delhi to provinces/localities.
- Regionalisation = local elite, military, zamindari, banking and cultural networks become durable political orders.
- Transition = Mughal forms survive while the location and social basis of force changes.
- One-line thesis: central command declined faster than Mughal legitimacy and institutions.

HIGH

REGISTER 02 - Sources and evidence disciplineGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 02 - SOURCES AND EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE - REVISION CORE**

Khafi Khan, *Muntakhab al-Lubab*: court and noble politics; elite/moralising limit.

REGISTER 02 - SOURCES AND EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Dargah Quli Khan, *Muraqqa-i Dehli*: Muhammad Shah's urban-cultural Delhi; Delhi-centred limit.
- Mirza Mahdi Khan Astarabadi, *Tarikh-i Jahangusha-yi Nadiri*: Nadir's campaign; triumphalist patronage limit.
- Farmans/sanads: 1717 Company privilege; 1718-19 Maratha settlement; claim is not implementation.
- Company records: precise trade disputes; commercial bias and inland limits.
- Coins/khutba/seals/architecture: symbolic legitimacy and patronage; not direct territorial control.
- Never fix legendary army, plunder or casualty numbers without source qualification.

HIGH

REGISTER 03 - Structural inheritance in 1707GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 03 - STRUCTURAL INHERITANCE IN 1707 - REVISION CORE**

Emperor allocated mansab, jagir, title and office.

REGISTER 03 - STRUCTURAL INHERITANCE IN 1707 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Jagir = transferable revenue assignment; khalisa = crown revenue.
- Jama = assessed; hasil = realised; gap = fiscal credibility problem.
- Administrative order: village → pargana → sarkar → subah.
- Subahdar and diwan were intended executive/revenue checks.
- Zamindars combined local rights, knowledge, forts and armed following.
- Strength: flexible imperial network. Vulnerability: delegated office could become hereditary power.

HIGH**REGISTER 04 - Succession and court chronology**GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 04 - SUCCESSION AND COURT CHRONOLOGY - REVISION CORE**

1707 Jajau: Bahadur Shah defeats Azam.

REGISTER 04 - SUCCESSION AND COURT CHRONOLOGY - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- 1709 Kam Bakhsh defeated.
- Bahadur Shah: able conciliator; partial Maratha settlement; Sikh campaign; finances worsen.
- 1712 Jahandar Shah/Zulfiqar Khan: strong-wazir experiment, conciliation, ijara risk.
- 1713 Farrukhsiyar installed by Sayyids.
- 1719 Farrukhsiyar deposed; Rafi-ud-Darajat, Shah Jahan II, Muhammad Shah.
- 1720 Sayyids overthrown; monarchy restored in form, not repaired in capacity.

HIGH**REGISTER 05 - Nobility and the Sayyid Brothers**GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 05 - NOBILITY AND THE SAYYID BROTHERS - REVISION CORE**

Faction labels: Turani, Irani, Afghan, Hindustani/Baraha, Deccani; fluid coalitions.

REGISTER 05 - NOBILITY AND THE SAYYID BROTHERS - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Competition: wizarat, mir bakhshi, governorship, jagir, seal and access.
- Sayyids: Abdullah Khan + Husain Ali; kingmakers, not emperors.
- Policies: jizya/pilgrim-tax abolition, Rajput/Jat accommodation, Maratha settlement.
- Structural symptom: emperor already depended on armed coalitions.
- Accelerant: deposition/killing of Farrukhsiyar damaged dynastic awe.
- Best verdict: capable administrators trapped in and deepening factional politics.

HIGH

REGISTER 06 - Jagirdari and fiscal debate · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 06 - JAGIRDARI AND FISCAL DEBATE · 1 - REVISION CORE**

Be-jagiri = inadequate/delayed suitable assignment.

REGISTER 06 - JAGIRDARI AND FISCAL DEBATE · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Mechanism: more claims → competition for productive jagirs → short extraction → rural resistance → less remittance → fewer troops.
- Frequent transfer prevented entrenchment but discouraged improvement.
- Khalisa grants placated nobles but weakened central cash.
- Ijara inserted revenue farmers with profit-driven extraction.
- Satish Chandra: structural jagirdari crisis.
- Irfan Habib: agrarian crisis and peasant/zamindar resistance.

HIGH

REGISTER 06 - Jagirdari and fiscal debate · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 06 - JAGIRDARI AND FISCAL DEBATE · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Richards: allocation and Deccan khalisa complicate real-versus-artificial shortage.

REGISTER 06 - JAGIRDARI AND FISCAL DEBATE · 2 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Regionalists: resources also shifted into expanding local networks.

HIGH

REGISTER 07 - Regional assertionsGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 07 - REGIONAL ASSERTIONS - REVISION CORE**

Jats: Churaman, Agra-Mathura, fortified zamindari and peasant base.

REGISTER 07 - REGIONAL ASSERTIONS - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Sikhs: Banda Bahadur, Lohgarh, Punjab mobilisation; misls are later.
- Rajputs: Jai Singh/Ajit Singh combined mansab and regional demands; no single bloc.
- Bundelas: Chhatrasal; accommodation and assertion.
- Zamindars: intermediary, armed local leader and potential ruler.
- Rule: identity mattered, but land, revenue, forts, leadership and opportunity made resistance durable.

HIGH

REGISTER 08 - Marathas and DeccanGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 08 - MARATHAS AND DECCAN - REVISION CORE**

Late Aurangzeb: mobile resistance survives fort campaigns.

REGISTER 08 - MARATHAS AND DECCAN - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Shahu versus Tarabai complicates Mughal bargaining.
- Bahadur Shah: sardeshmukhi concession, no full chauth settlement.
- 1718-19: swarajya + chauth/sardeshmukhi recognition linked to Sayyid alliance.
- Chauth approximately quarter claim; sardeshmukhi additional ten-per-cent claim.
- Baji Rao from 1720: offensive reach into Malwa/Gujarat/north.
- Maratha-Mughal relations included war, service, negotiation and factional alliance.

HIGH

REGISTER 09 - Successor statesGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 09 - SUCCESSOR STATES - REVISION CORE**

Formula: provincial office + regional army/resources + zamindar/finance coalition + nominal Mughal sanction.

REGISTER 09 - SUCCESSOR STATES - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Bengal: Murshid Quli Khan, 1717; survey, big zamindars, bankers, dynastic succession.
- Awadh: Saadat Khan, 1722; local chiefs, middle-Ganga base, continuing court ambition.
- Hyderabad: Nizam-ul-Mulk, 1724; Deccan force, war/treaty autonomy, coins/khutba continuity.
- Continuity in form, autonomy in substance.
- Not identical: Bengal commercial-fiscal; Awadh strategic agrarian; Hyderabad contested Deccan.

HIGH

REGISTER 10 - Military and economy · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 10 - MILITARY AND ECONOMY · 1 - REVISION CORE**

Army = noble contingents + artillery + cavalry + infantry + allies.

REGISTER 10 - MILITARY AND ECONOMY · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Paper mansab did not equal deployable force.
- Core military problems: arrears, incomplete contingents, divided command, logistics and frontier response.
- Nadir's edge: unified command, mobility, fire discipline and flexible artillery; not firearm monopoly.
- Economy: imperial remittance declined while regional treasuries and markets could grow.
- Bengal trade, Indian bankers and merchants show vitality.
- 1717 Company farman = commercial privilege, not sovereignty.

HIGH**REGISTER 10 - Military and economy · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 10 - MILITARY AND ECONOMY · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Delhi recovered after 1739; reject immediate all-India economic collapse.

HIGH**REGISTER 11 - Nadir Shah, 1739 · 1****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 11 - NADIR SHAH, 1739 · 1 - REVISION CORE**

Motives: Persian war finance + Indian wealth + Mughal frontier weakness; refugee dispute as pretext.

REGISTER 11 - NADIR SHAH, 1739 · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Route: Qandahar → Kabul → Peshawar → Lahore → Karnal → Delhi.
- Karnal: 24 February 1739; divided Mughal command versus integrated Persian force.
- Delhi: massacre after violence against Persian soldiers; casualty totals disputed.
- Took treasury, Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor; territories west of Indus ceded.
- Did not establish Persian rule over Delhi/Ganga plain.
- Effects: prestige collapse, frontier opening, fiscal shock, regional encouragement.

HIGH**REGISTER 11 - Nadir Shah, 1739 · 2****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 11 - NADIR SHAH, 1739 · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Caveat: decline and autonomy predated 1739; economy and legitimacy persisted.

HIGH

REGISTER 12 - Multi-causal interaction model · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 12 - MULTI-CAUSAL INTERACTION MODEL · 1 - REVISION CORE**

Deccan overstretch raised cost and claimant pressure.

REGISTER 12 - MULTI-CAUSAL INTERACTION MODEL · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Succession wars weakened arbitration and killed experienced personnel.
- Jagir/agrarian stress reduced revenue and troop maintenance.
- Factions converted scarcity into court warfare.
- Zamindars, Marathas, Jats and Sikhs reduced remittance and built alternatives.
- Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad retained provincial resources.
- Military-command weakness exposed frontier.

HIGH

REGISTER 12 - Multi-causal interaction model · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 12 - MULTI-CAUSAL INTERACTION MODEL · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Nadir accelerated timing and visibility.

REGISTER 12 - MULTI-CAUSAL INTERACTION MODEL · 2 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Ranking: structural core → political transmission → regional feedback → external shock.

HIGH

REGISTER 13 - ContinuitiesGS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 13 - CONTINUITIES - REVISION CORE**

Mughal dynasty and Timurid legitimacy survived.

REGISTER 13 - CONTINUITIES - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Coins and khutba retained emperor's name in successor states.
- Mansab, jagir, diwan, subah and Persian chancery vocabulary continued.
- Farman/sanad remained politically useful to Marathas and Company.
- Delhi remained symbolic; controlling imperial sanction mattered.
- Music, painting, manuscripts, architecture and Persianate etiquette continued and regionalised.
- Memory line: **form survived, force shifted.**

HIGH

REGISTER 14 - Historiography and source limits · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 14 - HISTORIOGRAPHY AND SOURCE LIMITS · 1 - REVISION CORE**

Sarkar: Aurangzeb/personality/moral-political decline; valuable chronology, reduction risk.

REGISTER 14 - HISTORIOGRAPHY AND SOURCE LIMITS · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- Satish Chandra: jagirdari-Deccan-administrative mechanism.
- Habib: agrarian extraction and resistance.
- Athar Ali: nobility and continuing imperial structure.
- Richards: policy and allocation qualification.
- Alam/Bayly: regional politics, commerce, credit and redistributed power.
- Best synthesis: central decline + regional transformation + uneven social costs.

HIGH

REGISTER 14 - Historiography and source limits · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 14 - HISTORIOGRAPHY AND SOURCE LIMITS · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Always attach school to evidence; never list names decoratively.

HIGH

REGISTER 15 - PYQ and answer spine · 1GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 15 - PYQ AND ANSWER SPINE · 1 - REVISION CORE**

2021 Prelims: Arcot/Hyderabad, Mysore/Vijayanagara, Rohilkhand/Durrani; inferred key B, official local key unavailable.

REGISTER 15 - PYQ AND ANSWER SPINE · 1 - CAUSAL AND COMPARATIVE LOGIC

- 2021 Prelims: pargana → sarkar → subah; inferred key A.
- 2022 GS-I Company armies: bounded later consequence; Company advantage was organisation-credit-revenue, not ethnicity.
- 10 marks: 2-3 named units + one qualification.
- 15 marks: 4-6 units + counter-evidence.
- 20 marks: 5-8 units + causal ranking + historiography/regional variation.
- Universal formula: define level → claim → named evidence → significance → limit → graded verdict.

HIGH

REGISTER 15 - PYQ and answer spine · 2GS-I Modern
Indian History**REGISTER 15 - PYQ AND ANSWER SPINE · 2 - REVISION CORE**

Final verdict: Mughal central authority declined; regional power and Mughal political culture continued in transformed form.